



Teachers: In first grade, students often study aspects of the world around them: the family, the school, the community, etc. The following guidelines are meant to broaden and complement that focus. The goal of studying selected topics in World History in first grade is to foster curiosity and the beginnings of understanding about the larger world outside the child's locality, and about varied civilizations and ways of life. This can be done through a variety of means: story, drama, art, music, discussion, and more.

The study of geography embraces many topics throughout the Core Knowledge Sequence, including topics in history and science. Geographic knowledge embraces a spatial sense of the world, an awareness of the physical processes that shape life, a sense of the interactions between humans and their environment, an understanding of the relations between place and culture, and an awareness of the characteristics of specific regions and cultures.

It is important that students learn about the people who shaped our world, as well as those who continue to do so. Thus, it is recommended that students listen to a variety of biographies. Engaging students in read-alouds about the individuals listed in the Sequence, as well as other people enables them to draw from a broader perspective.

World History and Geography

I. Geography

A. Spatial Sense (Working with Maps, Globes, and Other Geographic Tools)

Teachers: Foster students' geographical awareness through regular work with maps and globes. Have students regularly locate themselves on maps and globes in relation to places they are studying.

- Name your continent, country, state, and community.
- Understand that maps have keys or legends with symbols and their uses.
- Find directions on a map: east, west, north, south.
- Identify the major oceans: Pacific, Atlantic, Indian, Arctic, Southern.
- Review the seven continents: Asia, Europe, Africa, North America, South America, Antarctica, Australia.
- Locate: Canada, United States, Mexico, Central America, South America
- Locate: the Equator, Northern Hemisphere, Southern Hemisphere, North and South Poles

B. Geographical terms and features

- peninsula, harbor, bay, island, ocean, sea

II. Early World Civilizations

Teachers: As you introduce students to early civilizations, keep in mind the question, What is civilization? Help students see recurring features such as settling down, agriculture, building towns and cities, and learning how to write.

A. Mesopotamia: the "cradle of civilization"

- Importance of Tigris and Euphrates Rivers
- Farming methods, organized settlements
- Development of writing, why writing is important to the development of civilization
- Code of Hammurabi (early code of laws), why rules and laws are important to the development of civilization

The Southern Ocean is the *newest* named ocean basin. It is recognized by the U.S. Board on Geographic Names as the body of water extending from the coast of Antarctica to the line of latitude at 60 degrees South.

See also Visual Arts
Grade 1: Art from Long
Ago: Art of Ancient
Egypt.

Note: Students will be introduced to Hinduism and Buddhism in Grade 2, and examine Islam in more detail in Grade 4. They also examine lasting ideas from Judaism and Christianity in Grade 6.

Note: In older sources you may find these formerly used spellings: Mohammed, Mecca, Koran.

B. Ancient Egypt

- Geography
 - Transcontinental country (Africa and Asia)
 - Sahara Desert
- Importance of Nile River, floods and farming
- Pharaohs
 - Tutankhamen
 - Hatshepsut, woman pharaoh
- Pyramids and mummies, animal gods and goddesses, Sphinx
- Writing: hieroglyphics

C. History of World Religions

Teachers: Since religion is a shaping force in the story of civilization, the *Core Knowledge Sequence* introduces students in the early grades to major world religions, beginning with a focus on geography and major symbols and figures. The purpose is not to explore matters of theology but to provide a basic vocabulary for understanding many events and ideas in history. The goal is to familiarize, not proselytize; to be descriptive, not prescriptive. The tone should be one of respect and balance: no religion should be disparaged by implying that it is a thing of the past. To the question, “Which one is true?” an appropriate response is: “People of different faiths believe different things to be true. The best people to guide you on this right now are your parents or someone at home.”

- Judaism
 - Belief in one God
 - Story of the Exodus: Moses leads the Hebrews out of Egypt
 - Israel, Chanukah, Star of David, Torah, synagogue
- Christianity
 - Christianity grew out of Judaism
 - Jesus, meaning of “messiah”
 - Christmas and Easter, symbol of the cross
- Islam
 - Originated in Arabia, since spread worldwide
 - Followers are called Muslims
 - Allah, Muhammad, Makkah, Qur’an, mosque
 - Symbol of crescent and star (found on the flags of many mainly Islamic nations)

III. Modern Civilization and Culture: Mexico

Note: For historical connections, see American History Grade 1: Maya and Aztec civilizations; Conquistadors, Cortes, Moctezuma. See also Music Grade 1: “La Raspa”; Language Arts Grade 1: “Medio Pollito,” and Visual Arts Grade 1: Diego Rivera, The History of Medicine in Mexico (mural).

A. Geography

- North American continent, locate Mexico relative to Canada and the United States
- Central America, Yucatan Peninsula
- Pacific Ocean, Gulf of Mexico, Rio Grande
- Mexico City

B. Culture

- Indigenous and Spanish heritage
- Mexican flag
- Traditions: fiesta, piñata, Day of the Dead
- National holiday: September 16, Independence Day



Archaeological discoveries in North and South America, dating back 14,000 to 15,000 years, show that humans arrived on the continent 1,000 or even 2,000 years earlier than previously believed. According to a new theory, known as “Kelp Highway,” massive ice sheets covering western North America retreated allowing the first humans to arrive on the continent not only by foot but by boat. They traveled down the Pacific shore and subsisted on abundant coastal resources.

Note: Early exploration and the colonial years will be studied in greater depth and detail in Grade 3. First grade teachers should examine the Grade 3 guidelines to see how these topics build in the later grades.

Note: The now-familiar name “Powhatan” was used by English settlers for the leader whose name was Wahunsonacock.

American History and Geography

Teachers: The study of American history begins in grades K–2 with a brief overview of major events and figures, from the earliest days to recent times. A more in-depth, chronological study of American history begins again in Grade 3 and continues onward. The term “American” here generally, but not always, refers to the lands that became the United States. Other topics regarding North, Central, and South America may be found in the World History and Geography sections of this Sequence.

1

I. Early People and Civilizations

A. The Earliest People: Hunters and Nomads

- Crossing from Asia to North America (Beringian Land Bridge Theory or Kelp Highway)
 - From hunting to farming
 - Gradual development of early towns and cities

B. Early American Civilizations

Teachers: Students will study the Maya, Inca, and Aztec civilizations in detail in Grade 5. First grade teachers should examine the fifth grade guidelines to see how these topics build in the later grade. Here, introduce students to these civilizations. Though it is historically accurate to note the warlike nature of the Maya and Aztecs, it is recommended that mention of the practice of human sacrifice be left to the fifth grade.

- Maya in Mexico and Central America
 - Mayan Calendar
 - Culture: Farming methods, religious beliefs, temples
- Aztecs in Mexico
 - Moctezuma (also called Montezuma)
 - Tenochtitlan (Mexico City)
- Inca in South America (Peru, Chile)
 - Cities in the Andes, Machu Picchu

II. Early Exploration and Settlement

A. Columbus

Teachers: Review from kindergarten the story of Columbus’s voyage in 1492. Note that while Columbus Day is an important holiday for many Americans, in some states the holiday has been renamed Indigenous People’s Day in recognition of the harm that was caused to the indigenous peoples of the Americas by explorers, adventurers, and settlers from Europe. In fact, Columbus did enslave the Taino people and take them back to Europe with him. Although elements of Columbus’s story are dark, his voyages do mark a great change in the history of the world.

B. The Conquistadors

- The search for gold and silver
- Hernán Cortés and the Aztecs
- Francisco Pizarro and the Inca
- Diseases devastate Native American population

C. English Settlers

- The story of the Lost Colony
 - Sir Walter Raleigh
 - Virginia Dare
- Virginia
 - Jamestown
 - Captain John Smith
 - Pocahontas and Powhatan

See below, Symbols and Figures: Liberty Bell. See also Music Grade 1: "Yankee Doodle."

- Enslavement of people brought by force from Africa, plantations in Southern colonies
- Massachusetts
 - Pilgrims
 - Mayflower
 - Native Americans helped Pilgrims survive, Tisquantum (Squanto)
 - Thanksgiving Day
 - Massachusetts Bay Colony, the Puritans
 - Development of towns and cities

III. From Colonies to Independence: The American Revolution

Teachers: The American Revolution will be studied in greater depth and detail in Grade 4. First grade teachers should examine the fourth grade guidelines to see how these topics build in the later grade. It is recommended that first grade teachers focus on the topics specified here, and leave for fourth grade the more detailed study of the Revolution. In first grade, emphasize the story of the birth of our nation.

- Locate the original thirteen colonies.
- The Boston Tea Party
- Paul Revere's ride, "One if by land, two if by sea"
- The colonists were fighting the British to gain their freedom
- Minutemen and Redcoats, the "shot heard round the world"
- Thomas Jefferson and the Declaration of Independence, "We hold these truths to be self-evident, that all men are created equal . . ."
- Fourth of July
- Benjamin Franklin: patriot, inventor, writer
- George Washington: from military commander to our first president
 - Martha Washington
 - Our national capital city named Washington
- Legend of Betsy Ross and the flag

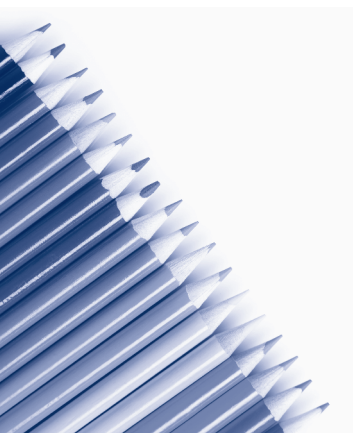
IV. Early Exploration of the American West

Teachers: America's westward growth will be studied in Grade 2 and in greater depth and detail in Grade 5. First grade teachers should examine the second and fifth grade guidelines to see how these topics build in later grades.

- Daniel Boone and the Wilderness Road
- The Louisiana Purchase
 - Explorations of Lewis and Clark (Corps of Discovery) Sacagawea
 - The Mandan Tribe and Fort Mandan
 - Port of New Orleans
- Geography: Locate the Appalachian Mountains, the Rocky Mountains, and the Mississippi River.

V. Symbols and Figures

- Recognize and become familiar with the significance of
 - Liberty Bell
 - Current United States president
 - American flag
 - Bald eagle



See also World History
Grade 1: Ancient Egypt.

Teachers: In schools, lessons on the visual arts should illustrate important elements of making and appreciating art, and emphasize important artists, works of art, and artistic concepts. When appropriate, topics in the visual arts may be linked to topics in other disciplines. The following guidelines specify a variety of artwork in different media and from various cultures in order to expose students to a wide range of art and artists. While the list is robust, it may require teachers to narrow the selection in order to adequately address the works and related skills within an academic year.

I. Art from Long Ago

Teachers: Help students see how art has been an important human activity since early times.

- Look at and discuss
 - Cave paintings
 - Running Horses from Cave of Lascaux
 - Art of Ancient Egypt
 - Great Sphinx
 - Tutankamen's Coffin
 - Bust of Queen Nefertiti

II. Elements of Art

Teachers: The generally recognized elements of art include line, shape, form, space, light, texture, and color. In first grade, focus on the following:

A. Color

Teachers: Review from Kindergarten the idea of "warm" and "cool" colors.

- Know that red, yellow, and blue are commonly referred to as the "primary colors," and that
 - blue + yellow = green
 - blue + red = purple
 - red + yellow = orange
- Observe the use of color in
 - *Tulips in Holland*, Claude Monet
 - McNeill Whistler, *Arrangement in Black and Grey (Whistler's Mother)*
 - Diego Rivera, *Piñata*
 - Romaine Brooks, *Emile d'Erlanger La Baronne* (1924)
 - Pedro Linares, *Alebríjes* (1930s)
 - Retablos
 - Dr. Atl (Gerardo Murillo), *Popocatepetl volcano* (1940)
 - Etel Adnan, *Explosion Floral* (1968/2018)

B. Line

- Identify and use different lines: straight, zigzag, curved, wavy, spiral, thick, thin
- Observe how different lines are used in
 - Jacob Lawrence, *Parade*
 - Henri Matisse, *The Swan*
 - Georgia O'Keeffe, *Shell*
 - John Audubon, *Trumpeter Swan* (1838)
 - Lola Álvarez Bravo, *El baño* (1930)
 - Elizabeth Catlett, *La Presa* (1952)
 - Leonard Freed, *Fire Hydrant* (1963)
 - Juan Quezada Celado, Mata Ortiz pottery (1970s)

See also World History
Grade 1: Mexico, re
piñata.

Compare Adnan to
Monet

Compare Audubon's
Trumpeter Swan to
Matisse

The Trumpeter Swan
can also be used to
address texture

C. Shape

- Recognize basic geometric shapes—square, rectangle, triangle, circle, oval—in nature, man-made objects, and artworks, including
 - Grant Wood, *Stone City, Iowa*
 - Sophie Taeuber-Arp, *Dada Head* (1920)
 - Marisol, *The Family* (1962)
 - Chuck Close, *Elizabeth* (1989)
 - Amy Bennett, *Nothing New Under The Sun* (2016)

D. Texture

Teachers: Provide opportunities for students to experience both tactile and visual texture (these terms are for your reference only) by having them describe qualities of texture in natural objects (tactile texture) and in works of art (visual texture)

- Describe qualities of texture (as, for example, rough, smooth, bumpy, scratchy, slippery, etc.) in
 - Native American Baskets
 - Edgar Degas, *Little Fourteen-Year-Old-Dancer*
 - Albrecht Dürer, *Young Hare*
 - Olga de Amaral, *Marea Azul* (2016)
 - Lina Iris Viktor, *In the Beginning was Chaos* (2020)

III. Kinds of Pictures

Teachers: Introduce students to the terms we use to describe different kinds of paintings, discuss examples, and provide opportunities for students to create their own works in different genres. When you look at the specified works, ask the students about their first impressions—what they notice first, and what the picture makes them think of or feel. Go on to discuss lines, shapes, colors, and textures; details not obvious at first; why they think the artist chose to depict things in a certain way, etc.

A. Portrait

- Recognize as a portrait or self-portrait:
 - Leonardo da Vinci, *Mona Lisa*
 - Francisco Goya y Lucientes, *Don Manuel Osorio Manrique de Zuñiga*
 - Vincent van Gogh, *Self-Portrait* [1889]
 - Frida Kahlo, *Self Portrait with Necklace of Thorns* (1940)
 - Horace Pippin, *Self-Portrait II* (1944)
 - Amy Sherald, *The Make Believer* (Monet's Garden) 2016

B. Still Life

- Recognize as a still life:
 - Vincent van Gogh, *Irises*
 - Paul Cézanne, *Apples and Oranges*
 - Clara Peeters, *Table with Orange, Olives and Pie* (1611)

C. Murals

- Recognize as a mural (a painting on a wall):
 - Diego Rivera, *The History of Medicine in Mexico*
 - David Alfaro Siqueiros, *The Revolution*

III. Architecture

- Discuss shape of architectural structures and the different ways they were used, such as
 - Ziggurat of Ur in Ancient Mesopotamia
 - Great Pyramids of Egypt
 - Teotihuacan: Pyramid of the Moon

See also World History
Grade 1: Mexico, re
murals of Diego Rivera.

Ask students to
think about why the
same forms would
be built in different
places in the world
without there being
any communication
between them
(as in the case of
Teotihuacán).



Teachers: In schools, lessons on music should feature activities and works that illustrate important musical concepts and terms, and should introduce important composers and works. When appropriate, topics in music may be linked to topics in other disciplines. The following guidelines focus on content, not performance skills, though many concepts are best learned through active practice (singing, clapping rhythms, playing instruments, etc.).

I. Elements of Music

- Through participation become familiar with basic elements of music (rhythm, melody, harmony, form, timbre, etc.).
 - Recognize a steady beat; moving to a beat; play a steady beat; recognize accents.
 - Move responsively to music (marching, walking, hopping, swaying, etc.).
 - Participate in play party activities and dance (e.g., *Chimes of Dunkirk*, *Les Saluts*)
 - Engage in improvisation activities (e.g., *Highway Number One*, *There was a Man and He was Mad*)
 - Recognize short and long sounds.
 - Discriminate between fast and slow.
 - Discriminate between obvious differences in pitch: high and low.
 - Discriminate between loud and soft.
 - Understand that melody can move up and down.
 - Hum the melody while listening to music.
 - Echo short rhythms and melodic patterns.
 - Participate in call and response activities (e.g., *Funga Alafia*, *Down By the Bay*, *Che Che Kule*).
 - Play simple rhythms and melodies.
 - Recognize like and unlike phrases.
 - Recognize that music has timbre or tone color.
 - Sing unaccompanied, accompanied, and in unison.
- Recognize (aurally) the following frequently used Italian terms:
 - *adagio* (slow)
 - *moderato* (medium) *allegro* (fast)
- Understand that music is written down in a special way and become familiar with the following notation:

Teachers: Consider introducing the count system for each note (i.e., “ta” for quarter notes and “ti ti” for eighth notes).

 - ♩ quarter note, ♪ eighth note

Also known as *Che Che Koolay*

Note to Teachers:

The expectation is that students understand what these words mean when spoken. It is not expected that they recognize the written words.

II. Listening and Understanding

Teachers: Expose students to a wide range of music, including children’s music, popular instrumental music, and music from various cultures.

A. Musical Terms and Concepts

- Composers
 - Know that a composer is someone who writes music.
 - Become familiar with Wolfgang Amadeus Mozart as a composer who wrote what is known as classical music, and listen to the Allegro (first movement) from *A Little Night Music* (*Eine kleine Nachtmusik*).

Note: Students will review families of instruments and specific instruments in later grades

Note: If resources are available, read aloud to students the story behind Tchaikovsky's *Nutcracker*, and either attend a performance or show scenes from the ballet, which is available on videotape. You may also wish to introduce students to the Suite from Tchaikovsky's *Sleeping Beauty*, in relation to the story in Language Arts Grade 1, "Sleeping Beauty."

- Orchestra
 - Become familiar with the families of instruments in the orchestra: strings, brass, woodwinds, percussion.
 - Know that the leader of the orchestra is called the conductor. Listen to Sergei Prokofiev, *Peter and the Wolf*.

B. Music Can Tell a Story

- Opera
 - Understand that opera combines music, singing, and acting.
 - Listen to selections from Humperdinck's *Hansel and Gretel*: "Brother, Come Dance with Me," "I Am the Little Sandman," "Children's Prayer."
- Instrumental Music
 - Listen to Paul Dukas, *The Sorcerer's Apprentice*.
- Ballet
 - Understand that ballet combines music and movement, often to tell a story.
 - Listen to *Tchaikovsky's Nutcracker Suite*.

Teachers: Familiarize students with other types of dance, such as square dancing and tap dancing.

C. American Musical Traditions

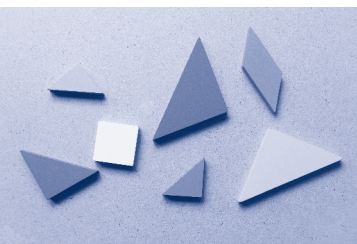
- Jazz
 - Understand that jazz is a kind of music that developed in America, with African and African American roots, and that jazz musicians improvise.
 - Recognize Louis Armstrong as a great early jazz musician. Listen to *What a Wonderful World*
 - Listen and dance to *Doin' the Suzie Q* (Lil Hardin Armstrong)

III. Songs

Teachers: You may also wish to teach students the song "Brother, Come Dance with Me" in connection with their introduction to the opera *Hansel and Gretel*. And you may wish to teach the poem "Thanksgiving Day" ("Over the river and through the wood") as a song (see Language Arts Grade 1: Poetry).

"My Country Tis of Thee"
"Dry Bones"
"For He's a Jolly Good Fellow"
"Frère Jacques"
"La Raspa"
"Make New Friends"
"Michael, Row the Boat Ashore"
"Oh, Dear, What Can the Matter Be?"
"On Top of Old Smokey"
"She'll Be Comin' 'Round the Mountain"
"Skip to My Lou"
"Take Me Out to the Ball Game"
"There's a Hole in the Bucket"
"When the Saints Go Marching In"
"Yankee Doodle"

Consider showing students a clip of Louis Armstrong performing "When the Saints Go Marching In"



Teachers: Mathematics has its own vocabulary and patterns of thinking. It is a discipline with its own language and conventions. Thus, while some lessons may offer occasional opportunities for linking mathematics to other disciplines, it is critically important to attend to math as math. From the earliest years, mathematics requires incremental review and steady practice: not only the diligent effort required to master basic facts and operations, but also thoughtful and varied practice that approaches problems from a variety of angles, and gives students a variety of opportunities to apply the same concept or operation in different types of situations. While it is important to work toward the development of “higher-order problem-solving skills,” it is equally important—indeed, it is prerequisite to achieving “higher order” skills—to have a sound grasp of basic facts, and an automatic fluency with fundamental operations.

Using objects and drawings

Using objects and drawings.

I. Operations and Algebraic Thinking

- Represent and solve problems involving addition and subtraction.
 - Use addition and subtraction within 20 to solve word problems, with unknowns in all positions, involving situations of
 - adding to
 - taking from
 - putting together
 - taking apart
 - comparing
 - Solve word problems that call for
 - addition of three whole numbers (whose sum is less than or equal to 20)
 - equations with a symbol for the unknown number to represent the problem
- Understand and apply properties of operations and the relationship between addition and subtraction.
 - Apply properties of operations (**commutative and associative**) as strategies to add and subtract.
 - Understand subtraction as an unknown-addend problem.
- Add and subtract up to 20.
 - Relate counting to addition and subtraction.
 - Add and subtract within 20 using strategies such as counting on, making ten, decomposing a number to a ten, and creating equivalent known sums.
 - Demonstrate fluency for addition and subtraction within 10.
- Work with addition and subtraction equations.
 - Understand the meaning of the equal sign.
 - Determine if equations involving addition and subtraction are true or false.
 - Determine the unknown whole number in an addition or subtraction equation relating three whole numbers.

II. Number and Operations in Base Ten

- Extend the counting sequence.
 - Count to 120, starting at any number less than 120.
 - Read and write numerals from 1–120.
 - Represent a number of objects with a written numeral.
- Understand place value.
 - Understand that the two digits of a two-digit number represent amounts of tens and ones: **10 as a bundle of ones, the numbers from 11–19 are a ten and ones, and that the multiples of ten refer to the number of tens.**
 - Compare two two-digit numbers based on meanings of the tens and ones digits.
 - Record the results of comparisons with the symbols $>$, $=$, and $<$.

Use concrete models or drawings and strategies based on place value, properties of operations, and/or the relationship between addition and subtraction

- Use place value understanding and properties of operations to add and subtract.
 - Add within 100, including
 - adding a two-digit number and a one-digit number
 - adding a two-digit number and a multiple of 10
 - Relate the strategy to a written method and explain the reasoning used.
 - Understand that in adding two-digit numbers sometimes it is necessary to compose a ten.
 - Given a two-digit number, mentally find 10 more or 10 less than the number.
 - Explain the reasoning used.
 - Subtract multiples of 10 in the range 10–90 from multiples of 10 in the range 10–90 (positive or zero differences).
 - Use concrete models or drawings and strategies based on
 - place value
 - properties of operations
 - the relationship between addition and subtraction
 - Relate the strategy to a written method and explain the reasoning used.

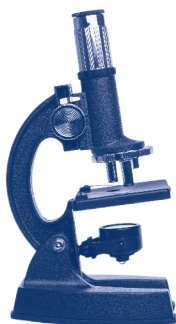
III. Measurement and Data

- Measure lengths indirectly and by iterating length units.
 - Order three objects by length.
 - Compare the lengths of two objects indirectly by using a third object.
 - Express the length of an object as a whole number of length units
 - Understand that the length measurement of an object is the number of same-size length units that span it with no gaps or overlaps when laid end to end.
- Tell and write time.
 - Tell and write time in hours and half-hours using analog and digital clocks.
- Represent and interpret data.
 - Organize, represent, and interpret data with up to three categories.
 - Ask and answer questions about the total number of data points.

Example questions:
how many in each category, or how many more or less are in one category than in another.

IV. Geometry

- Reason with shapes (**rectangles, squares, trapezoids, triangles, half-circles, quarter-circles, cubes, right rectangular prisms, right circular cones and right circular cylinders**) and their attributes.
 - Distinguish between defining attributes (e.g., triangles are closed and three-sided) versus non-defining attributes (e.g., color, orientation, overall size).
 - Build and draw shapes to possess defining attributes.
 - Compose two-dimensional and three-dimensional shapes to create a composite shape.
 - Compose new shapes from the composite shape.
 - Partition circles and rectangles into two and four equal shares.
 - Describe shares using the words *halves*, *fourths*, and *quarters*.
 - Use the phrases *half of*, *fourth of*, and *quarter of*.
 - Describe the whole as two of, or four of the shares.
 - Understand for these examples that decomposing into more equal shares creates smaller shares.



Teachers: Effective instruction in science requires hands-on experience and observation. In the words of the report from the National Academies of Science, *A Framework for K-12 Science Education*, "...children have surprisingly sophisticated ways of thinking about the world, based in part on their direct experiences with the physical environment, such as watching objects fall or collide and observing plants and animals. They also learn about the world through everyday activities, such as talking with their families, pursuing hobbies, watching television, and playing with friends. As children try to understand and influence the world around them, they develop ideas about their role in that world and how it works. In fact, the capacity of young children—from all backgrounds and socioeconomic levels—to reason in sophisticated ways is much greater than has long been assumed. Although they may lack deep knowledge and extensive experience, they often engage in a wide range of subtle and complex reasoning about the world. Thus, before they even enter school, children have developed their own ideas about the physical, biological, and social worlds and how they work. By listening to and taking these ideas seriously, educators can build on what children already know and can do."

While experience counts for much, book learning is also important, for it helps bring coherence and order to a child's scientific knowledge. Only when topics are presented systematically and clearly can children make steady and secure progress in their scientific learning. The child's development of scientific knowledge and understanding is in some ways a very disorderly and complex process, different for each child. But a systematic approach to the exploration of science, one that combines experience with book learning, can help provide essential building blocks for deeper understanding at a later time.

I. Sun, Moon, and Stars

Teachers: Through reading aloud, observation, and activities such as describing how the moon appears to change at different times of the month, explore the following with students:

A. The Sun and Its Predictable Patterns

- The sun is a star.
- Earth gets light and heat (thermal energy) from the sun.
- An Earth day (daytime and night together) is twenty-four hours.
- Sunrise and sunset happen because Earth, which is ball-shaped, rotates.

B. Annual Patterns of Sunrise and Sunset

- The times of sunrise and sunset vary a little each day and occur in predictable patterns.

C. The Moon and Its Predictable Patterns

- The moon, which is ball-shaped, is visible in the sky at night and often during the day.
- The moon appears to change shape over about a month; these changes are called the moon's phases (new, crescent, half, full).

D. Stars and Their Predictable Patterns

- Stars are distant objects that give off their own light.
- The positions of some stars are used to draw imagined patterns called constellations (Big Dipper, Orion).
- Stars appear to rotate across the sky in the course of a night.

II. Plant and Animal Survival

Teachers: Through reading aloud, observation, and activities such as investigating how various animals respond to different stimuli in their environment, help students to explore the following:

A. Structure and Function in Plants and Animals

- Plants and animals are composed of parts (structures), which they use in support of their survival.

Review and extend learning from Kindergarten, Needs of Plants and Animals.

B. Information Processing: Plant and Animal Stimulus and Response

- Animals and plants have parts that enable them to obtain and process information about their environment through their senses.
- Animals and plants respond to environmental inputs (stimuli) with behaviors that help them survive.

C. Growth and Development

- Adult plants and animals reproduce.
- Many kinds of animal parents take care of their offspring until the offspring become mature enough to care for themselves.

D. Parents and Offspring

- Traits are the characteristics of living things.
- Individuals of the same kind of animal or plant have similar traits, but they can also vary in many ways.

III. Exploring Light and Sound

Teachers: The emphasis in Grade 1 should be on observation, description, and explanation of real world experiences of light and sound, including how they can be used to solve problems; technical explanations of light and sound should be taken up in later grades; see Grades 4, 6, and 8 for an increasingly more detailed study of energy and waves:

A. Sound and Vibration

- Sound comes from sound waves that we detect with our ears.
- To vibrate means to move back and forth quickly. Vibrating matter can make a sound wave that can travel through many kinds of matter.

B. Light

- Light is a phenomenon we detect with our eyes.
- Some objects (the Sun, electric lights) give off light; most objects do not.

C. Light and Materials

- Light interacts differently with different types of materials.
 - Transparent
 - Translucent
 - Opaque
- The dark area created by an object blocking light is a shadow.
- Materials that reflect light may illuminate the surrounding space.

D. Solving Problems with Light or Sound

- People use light and sound in devices to solve problems.
- People use light and sound in a variety of devices to communicate over long distances.

IV. Simple Machines

Teachers: The emphasis in Grade 1 should be on observation, description, and explanation of real world applications of simple machines and how they are placed together to form compound machines; technical explanations of work, power, and force should be taken up in later grades; see Grade 8 for a detailed introduction to Physics:

A. Simple Machines

- A simple machine is a device that changes the strength or direction of a force (a push or a pull).

Review and extend learning from Kindergarten, Pushes and Pulls.

- There are six types of simple machines:
 - lever
 - wheel and axle
 - pulley
 - inclined plane
 - wedge
 - screw
- Simple machines make work easier because less force is used.

B. Compound Machines

- A compound machine consists of two or more simple machines working together.
- Examples of compound machines:
 - scissors
 - pencil sharpener
 - bicycle
 - wheelbarrow, and many other useful devices

V. The Human Body: Human Body Systems

A. Skeletal and Muscular Systems

- The skeletal system is made up of bones that provide structure to the human body and work with muscles to enable movement.
- The muscular system is made up of three types of muscle tissue:
 - cardiac, smooth, skeletal

B. Respiratory and Circulatory Systems

- The respiratory system performs an exchange of gases between the body and the atmosphere (breathing).
- The respiratory system interacts with the circulatory system to move matter back and forth between the lungs and cells in the body.
- The circulatory system is comprised of the body's blood, blood vessels, and heart.

C. Nervous System

- The nervous system is comprised of nerves and the brain.
- The nervous system interacts with all the body's other systems and controls all the body's voluntary and involuntary functions.

D. Taking Care of your Body

- Body systems require healthy choices to function properly.
- Neglecting health can lead to illnesses.

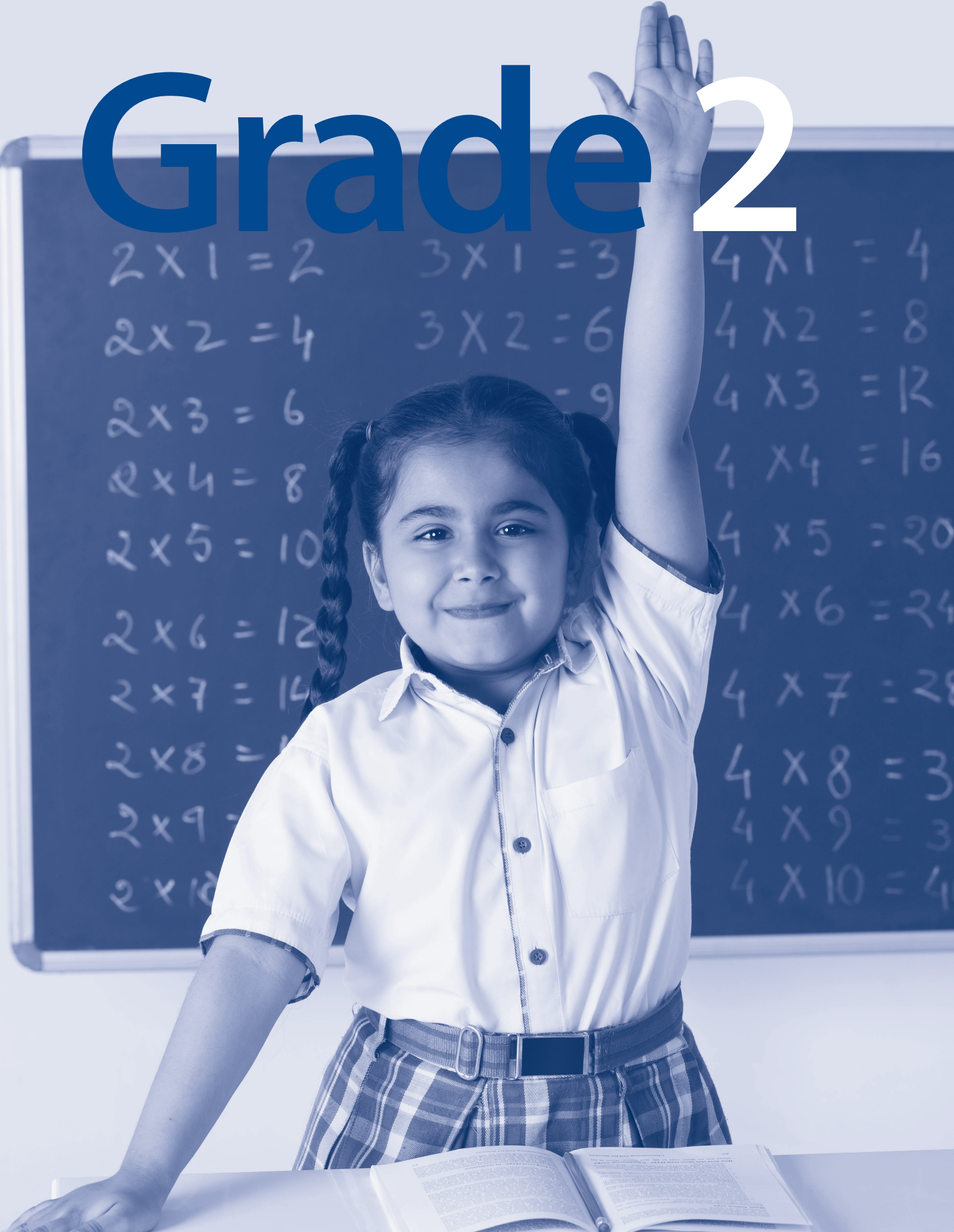
VI. Science Biographies

Teachers: Through reading aloud and activities, explore with students the stories and accomplishments of these scientists and engineers. This list of science biographies is by no means exhaustive. Other individuals can be incorporated into learning during a corresponding topic of study for this grade level, and should include:

- Galileo—astronomer, physicist, and engineer who observed planetary movement
- Shi Shen, Gan De, and Wu Xian—Chinese astronomers who developed ancient star charts
- Jacques Cousteau—explored the oceans, invented equipment for undersea exploration
- Gordon Gould—physicist who developed the laser
- Archimedes—Greek mathematician and inventor

Review and extend learning from Kindergarten, Our Five Senses.

Grade 2



$$2 \times 1 = 2$$

$$3 \times 1 = 3$$

$$4 \times 1 = 4$$

$$2 \times 2 = 4$$

$$3 \times 2 = 6$$

$$4 \times 2 = 8$$

$$2 \times 3 = 6$$

$$3 \times 3 = 9$$

$$4 \times 3 = 12$$

$$2 \times 4 = 8$$

$$4 \times 4 = 16$$

$$2 \times 5 = 10$$

$$4 \times 5 = 20$$

$$2 \times 6 = 12$$

$$4 \times 6 = 24$$

$$2 \times 7 = 14$$

$$4 \times 7 = 28$$

$$2 \times 8 = 16$$

$$4 \times 8 = 32$$

$$2 \times 9 = 18$$

$$4 \times 9 = 36$$

$$2 \times 10 = 20$$

$$4 \times 10 = 40$$

Overview of Topics

Grade 2

ENGLISH LANGUAGE ARTS

- I. Listening and Speaking
 - A. Classroom Discussion
 - B. Presentation of Ideas and Information
 - C. Comprehension and Discussion of Read-Alouds—All Texts
 - D. Comprehension and Discussion of Read-Alouds—Fiction, Drama, and Poetry
 - E. Comprehension and Discussion of Read-Alouds—Nonfiction and Informational Text
- II. Reading
 - A. Phonics: Decoding and Encoding
 - B. Oral Reading and Fluency
 - C. Reading Comprehension—All Texts
 - D. Reading Comprehension—Fiction, Drama, and Poetry
 - E. Reading Comprehension—Nonfiction and Informational Text
- III. Writing
 - A. Narrative Writing
 - B. Informative/Explanatory Writing
 - C. Persuasive Writing (Opinion)
- IV. Language Conventions
 - A. Spelling
 - B. Parts of Speech and Sentence Structure
 - C. Capitalization and Punctuation
- V. Poetry
- VI. Fiction
 - A. Stories
 - B. Mythology of Ancient Greece
 - C. American Folk Heroes and Tall Tales
 - D. Literary Terms

VII. Sayings and Phrases

HISTORY AND GEOGRAPHY

WORLD HISTORY AND GEOGRAPHY

- I. Geography
 - A. Spatial Sense
 - B. Geographical Terms and Features
- II. Early Asian Civilizations
 - A. Geography of Asia
 - B. India
 - C. China
- III. Modern Japanese Civilization
 - A. Geography
 - B. Culture
- IV. The Ancient Greek Civilization

AMERICAN HISTORY AND GEOGRAPHY

- I. American Government: The Constitution
- II. The War of 1812
- III. Westward Expansion
 - A. Pioneers Head West
 - B. Native Americans
- IV. The Civil War
- V. Immigration and Citizenship

VI. Fighting for a Cause

- VII. Geography of the Americas
 - A. North America
 - B. South America
- VIII. Symbols and Figures

VISUAL ARTS

- I. Elements of Art
- II. Sculpture
- III. Landscape
- IV. Abstraction
- V. Architecture

MUSIC

- I. Elements of Music
- II. Listening and Understanding
 - A. The Orchestra
 - B. Keyboard Instruments
 - C. Composers and Their Music
- III. Songs

MATHEMATICS

- I. Operations and Algebraic Thinking
- II. Number and Operations in Base Ten
- III. Measurement and Data
- IV. Geometry

SCIENCE

- I. Properties of Matter
 - A. Introduction to Matter
 - B. Properties and Uses of Matter
 - C. Heating and Cooling Matter
 - D. Building with Matter
- II. Organisms and Their Habitats
 - A. Plant Needs
 - B. Plant Diversity
 - C. Animal Needs
 - D. Animal Diversity
 - E. Ecosystems: Plant and Animal Relationships
- III. Exploring Land and Water
 - A. Landforms
 - B. Earth's Water
 - C. Effects of Wind and Water on Land
- IV. Electricity and Magnetism
 - A. Electricity
 - B. Magnets and Magnetism
 - C. Designing and Engineering Useful Devices
 - D. Safe Use of Electricity and Magnetism
- V. The Human Body: Cells and Digestion
 - A. Cells, Tissues, and Organs
 - B. Digestive and Excretory Systems
 - C. Taking Care of Your Body
- VI. Science Biographies

Grade 2 | English Language Arts



The *Common Core State Standards for English Language Arts* emphasize the critical importance of building nonfiction background knowledge in a coherent and sequenced way within and across grades. This can be accomplished most effectively, at each grade level, by integrating the topics from history, geography, science, and the arts in the *Core Knowledge Sequence* into the language arts block. Note that in the *Sequence*, there are many cross-curricular connections to history and science topics within Language Arts (e.g., poems, stories, and sayings), as well as to visual arts and music, which can and should be integrated into the applicable domain of study.

NOTE: The objectives listed in sections I–IV of Language Arts below are consistent with the *Core Knowledge Language Arts* program and embed all of the skills and concepts within the *Common Core State Standards for English Language Arts*.

2

I. Listening and Speaking

Teachers: Traditional language arts instruction has typically accorded little, if any, attention to the ongoing development of children's listening and speaking ability. This failure to focus on the development of oral language in language arts instruction has been a serious oversight. Literacy, the ability to read and write written language, is highly correlated with students' oral language proficiency, and the ability to understand a text read aloud is a prerequisite for making sense of the same text in printed form. It is therefore essential that children build listening and speaking competency while also developing reading and writing skills.

A. Classroom Discussion

- Maintain attention and actively participate in discussions about a variety of topics, ideas, and texts in both small and large group settings.
- Speak clearly with volume appropriate to the setting.
- Use agreed-upon rules for group discussions, i.e., look at and listen to the speaker, raise hand to speak, take turns, say "excuse me" or "please," etc.
- Ask questions to clarify conversations, directions, exercises, and/or classroom routines.
- Carry on and participate in a conversation over at least six turns, staying on topic, initiating comments or responding to a partner's comments, with either an adult or another child of the same age.
- Participate in a conversation or group discussion by making reference to, or building upon, a comment made by another person.
- Identify and express physical sensations, mental states, and emotions of self and others.
- Understand and use language to express spatial and temporal relationships (*up, down, first, last, before, after, etc.*).
- Understand and use narrative language to describe people, places, things, locations, events, actions.
- Understand and use common sayings and phrases such as "Don't judge a book by its cover" and "Better late than never."

B. Presentation of Ideas and Information

- Follow multi-step, oral directions.
- Give simple directions.
- Provide simple explanations.
- Recite a nursery rhyme, poem or song independently, using appropriate eye contact, volume and clear enunciation.
- Give oral presentations about personal experiences, topics of interest, stories, and summaries of factual information that have been presented orally, visually or through multimedia, using appropriate eye contact, volume and clear enunciation.

C. Comprehension and Discussion of Read-Alouds—All Texts

Teachers: Written text makes use of richer vocabulary and more complex syntax than conversational language. It is important that young children be exposed not only to the language of everyday conversation but also to the richer and more formal language of books. This can be done through frequent reading aloud. Helping young children develop the ability to listen to and understand written texts read aloud must be an integral part of any initiative designed to build literacy.

At the second grade level, students are becoming increasingly skilled as independent readers. Nevertheless, research indicates that reading comprehension ability does not catch up to listening comprehension until the middle school grades. It is therefore still important to provide second graders with extensive read aloud experiences of both fiction and nonfiction texts.

Careful consideration should be given to the selection of books read aloud to ensure that the vocabulary and syntax presented is rich and complex. Leveled texts will not provide the rich language experience desired during read-alouds and should only be used as a starting point with students for whom English is a second language.

Nonfiction read-alouds should be selected on the basis of the history, science, music and visual art topics identified for Grade 2 students in the *Core Knowledge Sequence*, with emphasis on history and science read-alouds. It is strongly recommended that daily read-alouds focus on a single topic over a sustained period of time—about two weeks—rather than intermingling read-alouds on a variety of subjects. Careful consideration should be given to the order in which nonfiction read-alouds are presented to ensure that knowledge about a topic builds in a progressive and coherent way.

Following any read-aloud, students should participate in rich, structured conversations with an adult in response to the written text that has been read aloud. In this way, they can begin to orally practice comparing, analyzing, and synthesizing ideas in written text in much the same way as they will be expected to do as independent readers in the later grades.

- Listen to and understand a variety of texts read aloud, including fictional stories, fairy tales, fables, historical narratives, drama, informational text, and poems.
- Distinguish the following genres of literature: fiction, nonfiction, and drama.

Grasping Specific Details and Key Ideas

- Describe illustrations.
- Sequence four to six pictures illustrating events in a read aloud.
- Answer questions requiring literal recall and understanding of the details and/or facts of a read-aloud, i.e., who, what, where, when, etc.
- Retell key details.
- Summarize in one's own words selected parts of a read-aloud.
- Ask questions to clarify information in a read-aloud.
- Use narrative language to describe people, places, things, locations, events, actions, a scene or facts in a read-aloud.

Observing Craft and Structure

- Understand and use words and phrases heard in read-alouds.
- Compare and contrast similarities and differences within a single read-aloud or between two or more read-alouds.
- Make personal connections to events or experiences in a read-aloud and/or make connections among several read-alouds.

Integrating Information and Evaluating Evidence

- Prior to listening to a read-aloud, identify what they know and have learned that may be related to the specific story or topic to be read aloud.
- Use pictures accompanying the read-aloud to check and support understanding of the read-aloud.
- Make predictions prior to and during a read-aloud, based on the title, pictures, and/or text heard thus far and then compare the actual outcomes to predictions.

- Answer questions that require making interpretations, judgments, or giving opinions about what is heard in a read-aloud, including answering “why” questions that require recognizing cause/effect relationships.
- Interpret information that is presented orally and then ask additional questions to clarify information or the topic in the read-aloud.
- Identify who is telling a story or providing information in a text.

D. Comprehension and Discussion of Read-Alouds—Fiction, Drama, and Poetry

- Retell a story, using narrative language to describe characters, setting(s), and the plot of the story in proper sequence.
- Compare and contrast characters from different stories.
- Describe characters in increasing depth by referring to their dialogue and/or actions in the story.
- Change some story events and provide a different story ending.
- Create and tell an original story, using narrative language to describe characters, setting(s), and the plot of the story in proper sequence.
- Distinguish fantasy from realistic text in a story.
- Identify the moral or lesson of a fable, folktale, or myth.
- Demonstrate understanding of literary language (e.g., author, illustrator, characters, setting, plot, dialogue, personification, simile, and metaphor) and use some of these terms in retelling stories or creating their own stories.
- Identify repetitions in phrases, refrains, or sounds in poems or songs.
- Identify sensory language and how it is used to describe people, objects, places, and events.
- Describe the use of rhyme, rhythm and sensory images used in poetry.

E. Comprehension and Discussion of Read-Alouds—Nonfiction and Informational Text

Teachers: Select nonfiction read-aloud topics from the second grade history, science, music, and visual arts topics, with emphasis on history and science.

- Generate questions and seek information from multiple sources to answer questions.
- Answer questions about the details of a nonfiction text, indicating which part of the text provided the information needed to answer specific questions.
- With assistance, categorize and organize facts and information within a given topic.
- With assistance, create and interpret timelines and lifelines related to read-alouds.
- Interpret information presented in diagrams, charts, graphs, etc.
- Distinguish read-alouds that describe events that happened long ago from those that describe contemporary or current events.

II Reading

A. Phonics: Decoding and Encoding

Teachers: Learning to read requires understanding and mastering the written English code through explicit and systematic phonics instruction. Research suggests that phonics instruction is most effective when specific letter-sound relationships are taught and reinforced by having students both read and write the letter-sound correspondence being studied. Reading and writing—decoding and encoding—are complementary processes that ensure mastery of the written code.

- Demonstrate understanding that a systematic, predictable relationship exists between written letters (graphemes) and spoken sounds (phonemes).
- Blend individual phonemes to pronounce printed words.
- Understand that sometimes two or more printed letters stand for a single sound.

- Read multi-syllable words containing any of the grapheme-phoneme correspondences listed below.
- Read and write words with inflectional endings, i.e., -s, -ed, -ing, -er, -est.
- Read, understand, and write contractions, i.e., *isn't*, *I'm*, *can't*, etc.
- Sort and classify words according to the spelling used to represent a specific phoneme.
- Read tricky spellings that can be sounded two ways, e.g., the letter 's' sounded /s/ as in *cats* and /z/ as in *dogs*.
- Read and spell chains of one-syllable words in which one sound is added, substituted, or omitted, i.e., read *at* > *cat* > *bat* > *bad* > *bid*.
- Read at least 100 words generally identified as high frequency words.

Consonant Sounds and Spellings Taught in Second Grade

/b/ spelled 'b' as in *boy*, 'bb' as in *tubby*
 /d/ spelled 'd' as in *dog*, 'dd' as in *madder*, 'ed' as in *filled*
 /f/ spelled 'f' as in *fun*, 'ff' as in *stuff*
 /g/ spelled 'g' as in *get*, 'gg' as in *egg*
 /h/ spelled 'h' as in *him*
 /j/ spelled 'j' as in *jump*, 'g' as in *gem*, 'ge' as in *fringe*
 /k/ spelled 'c' as in *cat*, 'k' as in *kitten*, 'ck' as in *sick*, 'cc' as in *moccasin*
 /l/ spelled 'l' as in *lip*, 'll' as in *sell*
 /m/ spelled 'm' as in *mad*, 'mm' as in *hammer*
 /n/ spelled 'n' as in *net*, 'nn' as in *funny*, 'kn' as in *knock*
 /p/ spelled 'p' as in *pet*, 'pp' as in *happy*
 /r/ spelled 'r' as in *red*, 'rr' as in *earring*, 'wr' as in *wrist*
 /s/ spelled 's' as in *sit*, 'ss' as in *dress*, 'c' as in *cent*, 'ce' as in *prince*, 'se' as in *rinse*
 /t/ spelled 't' as in *top*, 'tt' as in *butter*, 'ed' as in *asked*
 /v/ spelled 'v' as in *vet*, 've' as in *twelve*
 /w/ spelled 'w' as in *wet*, 'wh' as in *when*
 /x/ spelled 'x' as in *tax*
 /y/ spelled 'y' as in *yes*
 /z/ spelled 'z' as in *zip*, 'zz' as in *buzz*, 's' as in *dogs*
 /ch/ spelled 'ch' as in *chop*, 'tch' as in *itch*
 /sh/ spelled 'sh' as in *ship*
 /th/ spelled 'th' as in *thin*
 /th/ spelled 'th' as in *then*
 /qu/ spelled 'qu' as in *quick*
 /ng/ spelled 'ng' as in *sing*, 'n' as in *pink*

Vowel Sounds and Spellings Taught in Second Grade

/a/ spelled 'a' as in *cat*
 /e/ spelled 'e' as in *get*, 'ea' as in *head*
 /i/ spelled 'i' as in *hit*, 'y' as in *myth*
 /o/ spelled 'o' as in *hot*, 'a' as in *wall*
 /u/ spelled 'u' as in *but*, 'o' as in *son*
 /ae/ spelled 'a_e' as in *cake*, 'ai' as in *wait*, 'ay' as in *day*, 'a' as in *paper*, 'ey' as in *hey*, 'ei' as in *weight*, 'ea' as in *great*
 /ee/ spelled 'ee' as in *bee*, 'e' as in *me*, 'y' as in *funny*, 'ea' as in *beach*, 'e_e' as in *Pete*, 'ie' as in *cookie*, 'i' as in *ski*, 'ey' as in *key*
 /ie/ spelled 'i_e' as in *bike*, 'i' as in *biting*, 'y' as in *try*, 'ie' as in *tie*, 'igh' as in *night*

/oe/ spelled 'o_e' as in *note*, 'oa' as in *boat*, 'oe' as in *toe*, 'o' as in *open*, 'ow' as in *snow*
 /ue/ spelled 'u_e' as in *cute*, 'u' as in *unit*, 'ue' as in *cue*
 /aw/ spelled 'aw' as in *paw*, 'au' as in *Paul*, 'augh' as in *caught*, 'ough' as in *bought*
 /oo/ spelled 'oo' as in *look*, 'u' as in *student*, 'ue' as in *blue*, 'ui' as in *fruit*, 'ew' as in *new*, 'u_e'
 as in *tune*
 /oo/ spelled 'oo' as in *soon*
 /ou/ spelled 'ou' as in *shout*, 'ow' as in *now*
 /oi/ spelled 'oi' as in *oil*, 'oy' as in *toy*
 /er/ spelled 'er' as in *her*, 'ur' as in *hurt*, 'ir' as in *bird*, 'ar' as in *dollar*
 /ar/ spelled 'ar' as in *car*
 /or/ spelled 'or' as in *for*, 'ore' as in *more*, 'our' as in *four*, 'oor' as in *door*
 Schwa spelled 'a' as in *about*
 /shun/ spelled 'tion' as in *mention*

B. Oral Reading and Fluency

- Read decodable stories that incorporate the specific code knowledge that has been taught.
- Demonstrate increased accuracy, fluency, and expression on successive reading of a decodable text (90 wpm by the end of the year).
- Use phonics skills in conjunction with context to confirm or self-correct word recognition and understanding, rereading as necessary.
- Demonstrate understanding of and use commas and end punctuation while reading orally.
- Read aloud, alone, or with a partner at least 20 minutes each day.

C. Reading Comprehension—All Texts

Teachers: At the second grade level, students should be demonstrating ever-increasing code knowledge and fluency in their independent reading, allowing them to focus more intently on the meaning of what they are reading. This increased focus on reading comprehension is reflected in the number and complexity of the objectives below, as compared to earlier grades. However, it is important to remember that listening comprehension still far exceeds reading comprehension and that students' ability to talk about what they have heard and/or read will exceed their ability to demonstrate that understanding in writing.

- Demonstrate understanding of text—the majority of which is decodable—after independent reading.

Grasping Specific Details and Key Ideas

- Sequence four to six pictures illustrating events from a text that has been read independently.
- Answer questions requiring literal recall and understanding of the details and/or facts (i.e., who, what, where, when, etc.) about a text that has been read independently.
- Retell key details from a text that has been read independently.
- Summarize in one's own words selected parts of a text.
- Ask questions to clarify information about a text that has been read independently.
- Use narrative language to describe people, places, things, locations, events, actions, a scene or facts from a text that has been read independently.

Observing Craft and Structure

- Identify basic text features and what they mean, including title, table of contents, chapter headings and captions.
- Understand and use words and phrases from a text that has been read independently.
- Compare and contrast similarities and differences within a single text or between multiple texts read independently.

- Make personal connections to events or experiences in a text that has been read. independently and/or make connections among several texts that have been read independently.

Integrating Information and Evaluating Evidence

- Prior to reading, identify what they know and have learned that may be related to the specific story or topic to be read.
- Use pictures accompanying the written text to check and support understanding.
- Make predictions prior to and while reading, based on the title, pictures, and/or text read thus far and then compare the actual outcomes to predictions.
- Answer questions that require making interpretations, judgments, or giving opinions about what is read independently, including answering “why” questions that require recognizing cause/effect relationships.
- Interpret information that is read independently and then ask questions to clarify this information.
- Identify who is telling a story or providing information in a text.
- Identify temporal words that link and sequence events, i.e., *first, next, then*, etc.
- Identify words that link ideas, i.e., *for example, also, in addition*.

D. Reading Comprehension—Fiction, Drama, and Poetry

- Retell a story, using narrative language to describe characters, setting(s), and the plot of the story in proper sequence.
- Compare and contrast characters from different stories.
- Describe characters in increasing depth by referring to dialogue and/or their actions in the story.
- Change some story events and provide a different story ending.
- Distinguish fantasy from realistic text in a story.
- Identify the moral or lesson of a fable, folktale, or myth.
- Demonstrate understanding of literary language (e.g., author, illustrator, characters, setting, plot, dialogue, personification, simile, and metaphor) and use some of these terms in retelling stories or creating their own stories.
- Identify sensory language and how it is used to describe people, objects, places, and events.
- Identify repetitions in phrases, refrains, or sounds in poems or songs.
- Describe the use of rhyme, rhythm and sensory images used in poetry.

E. Reading Comprehension—Nonfiction and Informational Text

Teachers: Select nonfiction topics from the second grade history, science, music and visual arts topics with emphasis on history and science.

- Generate questions and seek information from multiple sources to answer questions.
- Answer questions about the details of a nonfiction text, indicating which part of the text provided the information needed to answer specific questions.
- Interpret information presented in diagrams, charts, graphs, etc.
- With assistance, categorize and organize facts and information for a given topic.
- With assistance, create and interpret timelines and lifelines related to text read independently.
- Distinguish text that describes events that happened long ago from text that describes contemporary or current events.

III. Writing

Teachers: Students develop ever increasing code knowledge and fluency in reading during second grade and, as a result, most will also become increasingly comfortable and competent in expressing their thoughts and ideas in writing.

Teachers should, however, have age-appropriate expectations about what second grade student writing should resemble. Students' spelling skills will often lag behind the code knowledge they demonstrate in reading. It is reasonable to expect that the students will use the letter-sound correspondences they have learned thus far to set down plausible spellings for the sounds in the word. For example, a student who writes *doller* for *dollar*, *wate* for *wait* or *weight* has set down a plausible spelling for each sound in the word, using the code knowledge taught in this grade. This should be seen as acceptable spelling for this stage of literacy acquisition. With continued writing practice, students should begin to include more dictionary correct spellings for words that they read and write frequently. Dictionary-correct spelling as the rule will be a realistic goal when students have learned more spellings, had repeated writing practice opportunities and have learned how to use a dictionary to check spelling.

At the second grade level, teachers should model and scaffold use of a writing process, such as "Plan-Draft-Edit," as students learn to write in various genres. It is important, though, not to dampen student enthusiasm for writing by rigidly insisting that *all* student writing be edited over and over again to bring the text to the "publication" stage. A sensible balance that encourages students to use their current skill knowledge when writing, as well as a simple editing rubric for review—without stifling creative expression—is optimal at the second grade level.

Writing to Reflect Audience, Purpose and Task

- Add details to writing.
- Begin to use tools, including technology, to plan, draft, and edit writing.

Conducting Research

- Gather information from experiences or provided text sources.

A. Narrative Writing

- Write a familiar story that includes setting(s), character(s), dialogue, and if appropriate, several events, using temporal words and phrases to indicate the chronology of events.
- Write a personal narrative.
- Create a title and an ending that are relevant to the narrative

B. Informative/Explanatory Writing

- Write about a topic, including a beginning and ending sentence, facts and examples. relevant to the topic, and specific steps (if writing explanatory text).
- Group similar information into paragraphs.
- Use linking words such as *also*, *another*, *and*, etc. to connect ideas within a paragraph.

C. Persuasive Writing (Opinion)

- Express an opinion or point of view in writing, providing reasons and supporting details for preference or opinion.
- Use words to link opinions with reasons or supporting details, such as *because*, *also*, *another*.
- Create a title that is relevant to the topic or subject of the text.
- If writing about a specific book or read-aloud, refer to the content of the text.

IV. Language Conventions

- Form sentences and paragraphs to communicate thoughts and ideas.
- Apply basic spelling conventions.
- Use basic capitalization and punctuation in sentences to convey meaning.

A. Spelling

- Write phonemically plausible spellings for words using current code knowledge, e.g., write *doller* for *dollar*, *wate* for *wait* or *weight*.
- Write words, phrases, and sentences from dictation, applying phonics knowledge.
- Alphabetize words to the second letter.

- Use a children’s dictionary, with assistance, to check spelling and verify the meaning of words.
- Identify and use synonyms, antonyms, homophones, and compound words.

B. Parts of Speech and Sentence Structure

- Recognize, identify and use subject, object, and possessive pronouns, i.e., *I, me, my, they, them*, orally, in written text and in own writing.
- Recognize, identify and use correct noun-pronoun agreement orally, in written text, and in own writing.
- Recognize, identify and use common and proper nouns, orally, in written text, and in own writing.
- Recognize, identify, and use the articles *a* and *an* appropriately orally, in written text, and in own writing.
- Recognize, identify and use selected regular and irregular plural nouns orally, in written text, and in own writing.
- Recognize, identify and use selected regular and irregular past, present, and future tense verbs orally, in written text, and in own writing.
- Recognize, identify, and use adjectives orally, in written text, and in own writing.
- Recognize, identify, and use adverbs orally, in written text, and in own writing.
- Recognize, identify and use subjects and predicates, orally, in written text, and in own writing.
- Recognize, identify, and use statements, questions, and exclamations orally, in written text, and in own writing.
- Recognize, identify, and use complete simple and compound sentences.

C. Capitalization and Punctuation

- Capitalize the first word in a sentence, the pronoun *I*, and proper nouns (names and places,) months, days of the week, titles of people, and addresses.
- Recognize, identify and use abbreviations with correct punctuation for the months, days of the week, titles of people, and addresses.
- Identify and use end punctuation, including periods, question marks, and exclamation points.
- Use commas appropriately in greetings and closings of letters, dates, items in a series, and addresses.
- Write a simple friendly letter.
- Use apostrophes to create contractions and indicate possession, i.e., *cat’s meow*.
- Use quotation marks appropriately to designate direct speech.

Note: The poems listed here constitute a selected core of poetry for this grade. You are encouraged to expose students to more poetry, old and new, and to have students write their own poems. To bring students into the spirit of poetry, read it aloud and encourage them to read it aloud so they can experience the music in the words.

V. Poetry

- “Bed in Summer” (Robert Louis Stevenson)
- “Bee! I’m expecting you” (Emily Dickinson)
- “Buffalo Dusk” (Carl Sandburg)
- “Caterpillars” (Aileen Fisher)
- “Discovery” (Harry Behn)
- “Harriet Tubman” (Eloise Greenfield)
- “Hurt No Living Thing” (Christina Rossetti)
- “Lincoln” (Nancy Byrd Turner)
- “The Night Before Christmas” (Clement Clarke Moore)
- “Rudolph Is Tired of the City” (Gwendolyn Brooks)
- “Seashell” (Federico Garcia Lorca)
- “Smart” (Shel Silverstein)

See below, Literary Terms—limerick, re Edward Lear.

“Something Told the Wild Geese” (Rachel Field)
 “There Was an Old Man with a Beard” (Edward Lear)
 “Who Has Seen the Wind?” (Christina Rossetti)
 “Windy Nights” (Robert Louis Stevenson)

Note: Review Drama from Grade 1, and engage students in dramatic activities, possibly with one of the stories below in the form of a play.

VI. Fiction

Teachers: The titles listed below are available in a variety of editions, including both adaptations for novice readers and others that lend themselves to reading aloud to children—for example, *Charlotte’s Web* or “How the Camel Got His Hump.” It is recommended that you provide a mixture of texts. Editions designed for beginning readers can help students practice decoding skills. Read-aloud texts, which the students may not be capable of reading on their own, can be understood when the words are read aloud and talked about with a helpful adult. Such active listening to vocabulary and syntax that go beyond the limits of grade-level readability formulas is an important part of developing an increasingly sophisticated verbal sense.

The titles below constitute a core of stories for this grade. Expose students to many more stories, including classic picture books, read-aloud books, etc. (In schools, teachers across grade levels should communicate their choices in order to avoid undue repetition.) Students should also be exposed to nonfiction prose—biographies, books on science and history, books on art and music—and they should be given opportunities to tell and write their own stories.

Note: “The Magic Paintbrush” is also known as “Tye May and the Magic Brush” and “Liang [or Ma Liang] and the Magic Brush.” See also World History Grade 2: India, re “The Blind Men and the Elephant” and “The Tiger, the Brahman, and the Jackal.”

A. Stories

“Beauty and the Beast”
 “The Blind Men and the Elephant” (a fable from India)
A Christmas Carol (Charles Dickens)
Charlotte’s Web (E. B. White)
 “The Emperor’s New Clothes” (Hans Christian Andersen)
 “The Fisherman and His Wife” (Brothers Grimm)
 “How the Camel Got His Hump” (a “Just-So” story by Rudyard Kipling)
 Iktomi stories (legends of the Plains Indian trickster figure, such as “Iktomi Lost His Eyes”; “Iktomi and the Berries”; “Iktomi and the Boulder”)
 “The Magic Paintbrush” (a Chinese folktale)
 “El Pajaro Cu” (a Hispanic folktale)
 selections from *Peter Pan* (James M. Barrie)
 “Talk” (a West African folktale)
 “The Tiger, the Brahman, and the Jackal” (a folktale from India)
 “The Tongue-Cut Sparrow” (a folktale from Japan)

B. Mythology of Ancient Greece

Teachers: See *World History and Geography 2: The Ancient Greek Civilization*.

- Gods of Ancient Greece (and Rome)
 - Zeus (Jupiter)
 - Hera (Juno)
 - Apollo (Apollo)
 - Artemis (Diana)
 - Poseidon (Neptune)
 - Aphrodite (Venus)
 - Demeter (Ceres)
 - Ares (Mars)
 - Hermes (Mercury)
 - Athena (Minerva)
 - Hephaestus (Vulcan)
 - Dionysus (Bacchus)

Note: Roman names are listed in parentheses because, although students do not study ancient Rome until third grade in the *Core Knowledge Sequence*, you are likely to encounter both Greek and Roman names in various books of myths you may use.

Note: Students will read more myths in third grade; see Language Arts Grade 3.

- Eros (Cupid)
- Hades (Pluto)
- Mount Olympus: home of the gods
- Mythological creatures and characters
 - Atlas (holding the world on his shoulders)
 - centaurs
 - Cerberus
 - Pegasus
 - Pan
- Greek Myths
 - "Prometheus" (how he brought fire from the gods to men)
 - "Pandora's Box"
 - "Oedipus and the Sphinx"
 - "Theseus and the Minotaur"
 - "Daedalus and Icarus"
 - "Arachne the Weaver"
 - "Swift-footed Atalanta"
 - "Demeter and Persephone"
 - Hercules (Heracles) and the "Labors of Hercules"

C. American Folk Heroes and Tall Tales

Teachers: Johnny Appleseed and Casey Jones were introduced in kindergarten.

- Paul Bunyan
- Johnny Appleseed
- John Henry
- Pecos Bill
- Casey Jones

D. Literary Terms

Teachers: In the course of their studies, students should learn the following terms:

- myth
- tall tale
- limerick

VII. Sayings and Phrases

Teachers: Every culture has phrases and proverbs that make no sense when carried over literally into another culture. For many students, this section may not be needed; they will have picked up these sayings by hearing them at home and among friends. But the sayings have been one of the categories most appreciated by teachers who work with students from home cultures that differ from the standard culture of literate American English.

Back to the drawing board
Better late than never
Cold feet
Don't cry over spilled milk.
Don't judge a book by its cover.
Easier said than done
Eaten out of house and home
Get a taste of your own medicine.
Get up on the wrong side of the bed.
In hot water

Keep your fingers crossed.
Practice what you preach.
The real McCoy
Two heads are better than one.
Turn over a new leaf.
Where there's a will there's a way.
You can't teach an old dog new tricks.

Grade 2 | History and Geography



Teachers: In second grade, students often study aspects of the world around them: the family, the school, the community, etc. The following guidelines are meant to broaden and complement that focus. The goal of studying selected topics in World History in second grade is to foster curiosity and the beginnings of understanding about the larger world outside the student's locality, and about varied civilizations and ways of life. This can be done through a variety of means: story, drama, art, music, discussion, and more.

The study of geography embraces many topics throughout the Core Knowledge Sequence, including topics in history and science. Geographic knowledge includes a spatial sense of the world, an awareness of the physical processes that shape life, a sense of the interactions between humans and their environment, an understanding of the relations between place and culture, and an awareness of the characteristics of specific regions and cultures.

It is important that students learn about the people who shaped our world, as well as those who continue to do so. Thus, it is recommended that students listen to a variety of biographies. Engaging students in read-alouds about the individuals listed in the Sequence, and others, enables them to draw from a broader perspective.

World History and Geography

See also below, American History and Geography: Geography of the Americas.

The Southern Ocean is the *newest* named ocean basin. It is recognized by the U.S. Board on Geographic Names as the body of water extending from the coast of Antarctica to the line of latitude at 60 degrees South.

I. Geography

A. Spatial Sense (Working with Maps, Globes, and Other Geographic Tools)

Teachers: Review and reinforce topics from Grade 1, including:

- Name your continent, country, state, and community.
- Understand that maps have keys or legends with symbols and their uses.
- Find directions on a map: east, west, north, south.
- Identify major oceans: Pacific, Atlantic, Indian, Arctic, Southern.
- The seven continents: Asia, Europe, Africa, North America, South America, Antarctica, Australia
- Locate: Canada, United States, Mexico, Central America, South America.
- Locate: the Equator, Northern Hemisphere and Southern Hemisphere, North and South Poles.

B. Geographical Terms and Features

Teachers: Review terms from Grade 1 (peninsula, harbor, bay, island), and add:

- coast, valley, prairie, desert, oasis

II. Early Asian Civilizations

Teachers: Since religion is a shaping force in the story of civilization, the Core Knowledge Sequence introduces students in the early grades to major world religions, beginning with a focus on geography and major symbols and figures. The purpose is not to explore matters of theology but to provide a basic vocabulary for understanding many events and ideas in history. The goal is to familiarize, not proselytize; to be descriptive, not prescriptive. The tone should be one of respect and balance: no religion should be disparaged by implying that it is a thing of the past. To the question, "Which one is true?" an appropriate response is: "People of different faiths believe different things to be true. The best people to guide you on this right now are your parents or someone at home."

A. Geography of Asia

- The largest continent, with the most populous countries in the world
- Locate: China, India, Japan, Pakistan

See also Language Arts
Grade 2: "The Tiger,
the Brahman, and the
Jackal," and "The Blind
Men and the Elephant,"
re India.

See also Visual Arts
Grade 2: Architecture:
Great Stupa, re
Buddhism.

See also Language Arts
Grade 2: "The Magic
Paintbrush."

Note: Students will
study feudal Japan in
Grade 5.

See also Language
Arts Grade 2: "The
Tongue-Cut Sparrow";
Visual Arts Grade 2:
Elements of
Art: Hokusai, *The Great
Wave*; and, Architecture:
The Katsura Palace.

See also Language
Arts Grade 2: Greek
Myths; Visual Arts
Grade 2: Sculpture,
Discus Thrower;
Architecture, The
Parthenon.

Note: Suggested
topics for learning
about Alexander
the Great include his
tutoring by Aristotle,
his horse Bucephalus,
and the legend of the
Gordian knot.

B. India

- Indus River and Ganges River
- Farming methods, organized settlements, written language made up of symbols
- Hinduism
 - Brahma, Vishnu, Shiva, Agni
 - Many holy books, including the Rig Veda
 - Diwali — Hindu Festival of Light
- Buddhism
 - Prince Siddhartha becomes Buddha, "the Enlightened One."
 - Buddhism begins as an outgrowth of Hinduism in India, and then spreads through many countries in Asia.
 - King Asoka (also spelled Ashoka)

C. China

Teachers: Students will study China again in Grade 4. Second grade teachers should examine the fourth grade guidelines to see how these topics build in the later grade.

- Yellow (Huang He) and Yangtze (Chang Jiang) Rivers
- Farming methods, organized settlements, written language made up of symbols
- Inventions of paper and fireworks
- Chinese written language (possibly oldest written language still used today)
- Teachings of Confucius (for example, honor your ancestors)
- Great Wall of China
- Invention of paper
- Importance of silk
- Chinese New Year

III. Modern Japanese Civilization

A. Geography

- Locate relative to continental Asia: "land of the rising sun."
- A country made up of islands; four major islands
- Pacific Ocean, Sea of Japan (East Sea)
- Mt. Fuji
- Tokyo

B. Culture

- Japanese flag
- Big modern cities, centers of industry and business
- Traditional craft: origami
- Traditional costume: kimono
- Tea ceremony

IV. The Ancient Greek Civilization

Teachers: Students will study Greece again in Grade 6, with a focus on the legacy of ideas from ancient Greece and Rome.

- Geography: Mediterranean Sea and Aegean Sea, Crete
- Athens and Sparta as a city-state: the beginnings of democracy
- Persian Wars: Marathon and Thermopylae
- Olympic Games



- Mount Olympus, worship of gods and goddesses
- Great thinkers: Socrates, Plato, and Aristotle
- Alexander the Great

American History and Geography

Teachers: The study of American history begins in grades K-2 with a brief overview of major events and figures, from the earliest days to recent times. A more in-depth, chronological study of American history begins again in Grade 3 and continues onward. The term “American” here generally, but not always, refers to the lands that became the United States. Other topics regarding North, Central, and South America may be found in the World History and Geography sections of this Sequence.

I. American Government: The Constitution

Teachers: Through analogies to familiar settings—the family, the school, the community—discuss some basic questions regarding American government, such as: “What is government?” “What are some basic functions of American government?” (Making and enforcing laws; settling disputes; protecting rights and liberties, etc.) Only basic questions need to be addressed at this grade level. In fourth grade students will examine in more detail specific issues and institutions of American government, including, for example, the separation of powers, and the relation between state and federal government.

- American government is based on the Constitution, the highest law of our land.
- James Madison, the “Father of the Constitution”
- Government by the consent of the governed: “We the people”

II. The War of 1812

- President James Madison and Dolley Madison
- British impressment of American sailors
- Old Ironsides
- Charles Ball, and other former slaves, who choose to fight the British in exchange for the promise of freedom
- British burn the White House.
- Fort McHenry, Francis Scott Key, and “The Star-Spangled Banner”
- Battle of New Orleans, Andrew Jackson

III. Westward Expansion

Teachers: Students will study Westward Expansion in greater depth and detail in Grade 5. Second grade teachers should examine the fifth grade guidelines to see how these topics build in the later grade. It is recommended that second grade teachers keep their focus on the people and events specified here, and leave for fifth grade the figures and ideas specified for that grade.

A. Pioneers Head West

- New means of travel
 - Robert Fulton, invention of the steamboat
 - Erie Canal
 - Railroads: the Transcontinental Railroad
- Routes west: wagon trains on the Oregon Trail, the Wilderness Road
- California Gold Rush
- The Pony Express

B. Native Americans

- Sequoyah and the Cherokee alphabet
- Forced removal to reservations: the “Trail of Tears”

- Some Native Americans displaced from their homes and ways of life by railroads (the “iron horse”).
- Effect of near extermination of bison on Plains Indigenous People

IV. The Civil War

Teachers: Students will study the Civil War in greater depth and detail in Grade 5. Second grade teachers should examine the fifth grade guidelines to see how these topics build in the later grade.

- Controversy over enslaved workers
- Plantations, plantation crops
- Harriet Tubman, the “underground railroad”
- Fort Sumter
- Northern v. Southern states: Yankees and Rebels
- Ulysses S. Grant and Robert E. Lee
- Clara Barton, “Angel of the Battlefield,” founder of American Red Cross
- President Abraham Lincoln: keeping the Union together
- Appomattox Court House
- Emancipation Proclamation and the end of slavery

V. Immigration and Citizenship

Teachers: Students will study Immigration and Urbanization in greater depth and detail in Grade 6. Second grade teachers should examine the sixth grade American History guidelines to see how these topics build in the later grade. In second grade, it is recommended that teachers use narrative, biography, and other accessible means to introduce students to the idea that many people have come to America (and continue to come here) from all around the world for many reasons: to find freedom, to seek a better life, to leave behind bad conditions in their native lands, etc. Discuss with students: What is an immigrant? Why do people leave their home countries to make a new home in America? What is it like to be a newcomer in America? What hardships have immigrants faced? What opportunities have they found?

- America perceived as a “land of opportunity”
- The meaning of “e pluribus unum” (a national motto you can see on the back of coins)
- Ellis Island and the significance of the Statue of Liberty
- Millions of newcomers to America
 - Large populations of immigrants settle in major cities (such as New York, Chicago, Philadelphia, Detroit, Cleveland, Boston, San Francisco)
- The idea of citizenship: What it means to be a citizen of a nation
 - American citizens have certain rights and responsibilities (for example, voting, eligible to hold public office, paying taxes).
 - Becoming an American citizen (by birth, naturalization)

Note: In Grade 4, students will study, in the historical context of antebellum reform, early pioneers in the women’s movement in America, including Elizabeth Cady Stanton, Lucretia Mott, Margaret Fuller, and Sojourner Truth.

Note: Students will study the modern American civil rights movement in more depth and detail in the middle school grades.

VI. Fighting for a Cause

Teachers: Through narrative, biography, and other accessible means, introduce students to the idea that while America is a country founded upon “the proposition that all men are created equal,” equality has not always been granted to all Americans. Many people, however, have dedicated themselves to the struggle to extend equal rights to all Americans. Specific figures and issues to study include:

- Susan B. Anthony and the right to vote
- Eleanor Roosevelt and civil rights and human rights
- Mary McLeod Bethune and educational opportunity
- Ruby Bridges and equitable access in public school education
- Jackie Robinson and the integration of major league baseball

Chief Standing Bear was the first Native American to speak before a Federal Court. He spoke out against the removal of his people from their land.

- Rosa Parks and the bus boycott in Montgomery, Alabama
- Martin Luther King, Jr. and the dream of equal rights for all
- Cesar Chavez and the rights of migrant workers
- Chief Standing Bear and the rights of Native Americans
- Sylvia Mendez and American civil rights

VII. Geography of the Americas

A. North America

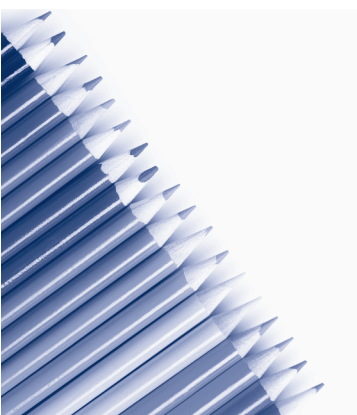
- North America: Canada, United States, Mexico
- The United States
 - Fifty states: Forty-eight contiguous states, plus Alaska and Hawaii
 - Current territories (American Samoa, Guam, Puerto Rico, and U.S. Virgin Islands)
 - Mississippi River
 - Appalachian and Rocky Mountains
 - Great Lakes
- Atlantic and Pacific Oceans, Gulf of Mexico, Caribbean Sea, West Indies
- Central America

B. South America

- Brazil: largest country in South America, Amazon River, rain forests
- Peru and Chile: Andes Mountains
- Locate: Venezuela, Colombia, Ecuador
- Bolivia: named after Simon Bolivar, "The Liberator"
- Argentina: the Pampas
- Main languages: Spanish and (in Brazil) Portuguese

VIII. Symbols and Figures

- Recognize and become familiar with the significance of
 - U. S. flag: current and earlier versions
 - Statue of Liberty
 - Lincoln Memorial



See also World History
Grade 2: Japan, re
Hokusai

Teachers: In schools, lessons on the visual arts should illustrate important elements of making and appreciating art, and emphasize important artists, works of art, and artistic concepts. When appropriate, topics in the visual arts may be linked to topics in other disciplines. The following guidelines specify a variety of artwork in different media and from various cultures in order to expose students to a wide range of art and artists. While the list is robust, it may require teachers to narrow the selection in order to adequately address the works and related skills within an academic year.

I. Elements of Art

Teachers: The generally recognized elements of art include line, shape, form, space, light, texture, and color. In second grade, continue when appropriate to discuss qualities of line, shape, color, and texture that students learned about in kindergarten and first grade.

- Recognize lines as horizontal, vertical, or diagonal.
- Observe the use of implied line/movement in:
 - Katsusika Hokusai, *The Great Wave at Kanagawa*
 - Pablo Picasso, *Mother and Child*
 - Yu Hong, *A Man Playing the Hula Hoop*, 1992
 - Liu Xiaodong, *My Hometown*, (2014)

II. Sculpture

- Observe shape, mass, and line in sculptures, including
 - Myron of Athens, *Discus Thrower*
 - (Ancient China) *Flying Horse, One Leg Resting on a Swallow*
 - Auguste Rodin, *The Thinker*
 - Ruth Asawa, *Installation View* (1960)
 - Yin Xiuzhen, *Portable City: Hangzhou* (2011)
 - Cai Guo-Qiang, *Sky Ladder* (2015)

See also World History
Grade 2: The Ancient
Greek Civilization, re
The Discus Thrower; and
China, re *Flying Horse*.

III. Landscape

Teachers: Briefly review from Grade 1: portrait, self-portrait, and still life. In discussing the following works, ask the students about their first impressions—what they notice first, and what the picture makes them think of or feel. Go on to discuss lines, shapes, colors, and textures; details not obvious at first; why they think the artist chose to depict things in a certain way, etc.

- Recognize as landscapes and discuss
 - Thomas Cole, *View from Mount Holyoke, Northampton, Massachusetts after a Thunderstorm- The Oxbow*
 - El Greco, *View of Toledo*
 - Henri Rousseau, *Virgin Forest at Sunset*
 - Van Gogh, *The Starry Night*
 - Clementine Hunter, *Murals*, (1955)
 - Richard Mayhew, *Vista* (2004)
 - Xing Danwen, *Urban Fiction No. 13* (2005)
 - David Hockney, *Bigger Trees Near Warter* (2007)
 - Lois Dodd, *Night House with Lit Window* (2012)
 - Julie Mehretu, *Fever graph (algorithm for serendipity)* (2013)
 - D.Y. Begay, *Winter in the North* (2018)

Note: You may wish to recall from kindergarten, Joan Miró, *People and Dog in the Sun*.

IV. Abstraction

- Compare lifelike and abstract animals, including
 - Albrecht Dürer, *Young Hare*
 - Paul Klee, *Cat and Bird*
 - Pablo Picasso, *Bull's Head*
 - Elaine Marie de Kooning, *Baseball Players*
 - Henri Matisse, *The Snail*
 - John James Audubon, *Passenger Pigeon*
- Observe and discuss examples of abstract painting and sculpture, including
 - Marc Chagall, *I and the Village*
 - Constantin Brancusi, *Bird in Space*

V. Architecture

See also World History Grade 2: The Ancient Greek Civilization, re the Parthenon; India, re the Great Stupa; Japan, re the Katsura Palace.

- Understand architecture as the art of designing buildings.
- Understand symmetry and a line of symmetry, and observe symmetry in the design of some buildings (such as the Parthenon).
 - Symmetry versus asymmetry (comparing the Parthenon to the Katsura Palace)
- Interior space versus exterior (comparing the Great Mosque to the Lakshmana Temple).
- Noting line, shape, and special features (such as columns and domes), look at
 - The Parthenon
 - Great Stupa (Buddhist temple in Sanchi, India)
 - The Baths of Diocletian
 - The Great Mosque of Cordoba
 - The Lakshmana Temple, Khajuraho
 - The Katsura Palace

Note: Also known as the Katsura Imperial Villa or Katsura Detached Palace. Call attention to the inspiration of Asian Gardens and the shift from symmetry to asymmetry that occurred at the time in the 19th century European Architecture in the Gothic Revival (see Grade 6) The way space is organized inspired 20th century architects (see Frank Lloyd Wright in Grade 7).



Teachers: In schools, lessons on music should feature activities and works that illustrate important musical concepts and terms, and should introduce important composers and works. When appropriate, topics in music may be linked to topics in other disciplines.

The following guidelines focus on content, not performance skills, though many concepts are best learned through active practice (singing, clapping rhythms, playing instruments, etc.).

I. Elements of Music

- Through participation, become familiar with basic elements of music (rhythm, melody, harmony, form, timbre, etc.).
 - Recognize a steady beat, accents, and the downbeat; play a steady beat.
 - Move responsively to music (marching, walking, hopping, swaying, etc.).
 - Recognize short and long sounds.
 - Discriminate between fast and slow; gradually slowing down and getting faster.
 - Discriminate between differences in pitch: high and low.
 - Discriminate between loud and soft; gradually increasing and decreasing volume.
 - Understand that melody can move up and down.
 - Hum the melody while listening to music.
 - Echo short rhythms and melodic patterns.
 - Engage in improvisation activities (e.g., *Bum, Bum, Bum Here We Come*)
 - Participate in call and response activities (e.g., *My Aunt Came Back, Oh Won't You Sit Down?*)
 - Participate in simple rounds (e.g., *Canoe Song*)
 - Sing Partner Songs (e.g., *This Old Man, Michael Finnegan*)
 - Dance and echo rhythm (e.g., *Miss Mary Mack, Alabama Gal*)
 - Play simple rhythms and melodies.
 - Recognize like and unlike phrases.
 - Recognize timbre (tone color).
 - Sing unaccompanied, accompanied, and in unison.
 - Recognize verse and refrain.
 - Recognize that musical notes have names.
 - Recognize a scale as a series of notes.
 - Sing the C major scale using "do re mi," etc.
- Recognize (aurally) the following frequently used Italian terms:
 - Review
 - *adagio* (slow)
 - *moderato* (medium)
 - *allegro* (fast)
 - Introduce
 - *piano* (soft)
 - *forte* (loud)
- Understand the following notation:
 - ≡ staff,  treble clef, names of lines and spaces in the treble clef
 -  whole note,  half note,  quarter note,  eighth note
 -  quarter rest,  eighth rest
 - *p* piano *f* forte

II. Listening and Understanding

Teachers: Expose students to a wide range of music, including children's music, popular instrumental music, and music from various cultures.

Note: In third grade, students will take a closer look at the brass and woodwind families.

Note: If you have recordings or other resources, also introduce African drumming and Latin American music with percussion.

See also below, Composers and Their Music, Bach, "Toccata and Fugue in D minor" (organ).

See also Language Arts Grade 2: American Tall Tales, re "Casey Jones," and "John Henry."

See also American History Grade 2: Civil War, re "Follow the Drinking Gourd," and "When Johnny Comes Marching Home."

See also American History Grade 2: War of 1812, re "The Star-Spangled Banner."

A. The Orchestra

- Review families of instruments: strings, brass, woodwinds, percussion.
- Become familiar with instruments in the string family—violin, viola, cello, double bass—and listen to
 - Camille Saint-Saëns, from *Carnival of the Animals*: "The Swan" (cello) and "Elephants" (double bass)
 - Antonio Vivaldi, *The Four Seasons* (see below, Composers and Their Music)
- Become familiar with instruments in the percussion family—for example, drums (timpani, snare), xylophone, wood block, maracas, cymbals, triangle, tambourine—and listen to
 - Carlos Chavez, *Toccata for Percussion*, third movement.
 - Evelyn Glennie, *A Little Prayer*
 - Abing (Hua Yanjun), *The Moon's Reflection on the Second Spring*
 - Heitor Villa-Lobos, *O Polichinelo*

B. Keyboard Instruments

- Recognize that the piano and organ are keyboard instruments, and listen to a variety of keyboard music, including:
 - Wolfgang Amadeus Mozart, "Rondo Alla Turca" from *Piano Sonata K. 331*
 - Ludwig van Beethoven, "Für Elise"
 - Felix Mendelssohn, from *Songs without Words*, "Spring Song"
 - Fanny Mendelssohn, "piano trio in d minor, op. 11"

C. Composers and Their Music

Teachers: Provide brief, child-friendly biographical profiles of the following composers, and listen to representative works:

- Antonio Vivaldi, *The Four Seasons*
- Johann Sebastian Bach, *Minuet in G major* (collected by Bach in the *Anna Magdalena Notebook*); *Jesu, Joy of Man's Desiring*; *Toccata and Fugue in D minor*
- Ludwig van Beethoven, *Symphony No. 6 ("Pastoral")*: first movement and from final movement, "Thunderstorm" to end of symphony

III. Songs

- "Casey Jones" (chorus only)
- "Do-Re-Mi"
- "The Erie Canal"
- "Follow the Drinking Gourd"
- "Good Bye Old Paint"
- "Home on the Range"
- "John Henry"
- "Old Dan Tucker"
- "The Star-Spangled Banner"
- "Swing Low, Sweet Chariot"
- "This Land Is Your Land"
- "When Johnny Comes Marching Home"
- "If You Miss Me From the Back of the Bus"
- "De Colores"
- "Jambo Bwana"
- "Song of the Volga Boatmen"



By end of Grade 2, know from memory all sums of two one-digit numbers.

Teachers: Mathematics has its own vocabulary and patterns of thinking. It is a discipline with its own language and conventions. Thus, while some lessons may offer occasional opportunities for linking mathematics to other disciplines, it is critically important to attend to math as math. From the earliest years, mathematics requires incremental review and steady practice: not only the diligent effort required to master basic facts and operations, but also thoughtful and varied practice that approaches problems from a variety of angles, and gives students a variety of opportunities to apply the same concept or operation in different types of situations. While it is important to work toward the development of “higher-order problem-solving skills,” it is equally important—indeed, it is prerequisite to achieving higher order skills—to have a sound grasp of basic facts, and an automatic fluency with fundamental operations.

2

I. Operations and Algebraic Thinking

- Represent and solve problems involving addition and subtraction.
 - Use addition and subtraction within 100 to solve one- and two-step word problems.
 - Solve word problems that involve situations of adding to, taking from, putting together, taking apart, and comparing, with unknowns in all positions.
 - Use equations with a symbol for the unknown number to represent the problem.
- Add and subtract within 20.
 - Fluently add and subtract within 20 using mental strategies.
- Work with equal groups of objects to gain foundations for multiplication.
 - Determine whether a group of objects (up to 20) has an odd or even number of members.
 - Write an equation to express an even number as a sum of two equal addends.
 - Use addition to find the total number of objects arranged in rectangular arrays with up to 5 rows and up to 5 columns.
 - Write an equation to express the total as a sum of equal addends.

II. Number and Operations in Base Ten

- Understand place value.
 - Understand that the three digits of a three-digit number represent amounts of hundreds, tens, and ones.
 - Count within 1000.
 - Skip-count by 5s, 10s, and 100s.
 - Read and write numbers to 1000, using
 - base-ten numerals
 - number names
 - expanded form
 - Compare two three-digit numbers based on meanings of the hundreds, tens, and ones digits.
 - Use $>$, $=$, and $<$ symbols to record the results of comparisons.
- Use place value understanding and properties of operations to add and subtract.
 - Fluently add and subtract within 100.
 - Use strategies based on
 - place value
 - properties of operations
 - relationship between addition and subtraction
 - Add up to four two-digit numbers.
 - Use strategies based on
 - place value
 - properties of operations

- Add and subtract within 1000.
 - Understand that when adding or subtracting three digit numbers sometimes it is necessary to compose or decompose tens or hundreds.
 - Use concrete models or drawings and strategies based on
 - place value
 - properties of operations
 - relationship between addition and subtraction
- Relate the applied strategy to a written method.
 - Mentally add 10 or 100 to a given number 100–900.
 - Mentally subtract 10 or 100 from a given number 100–900.
 - Explain why addition and subtraction strategies work.
 - Use place value and the properties of operations.

III. Measurement and Data

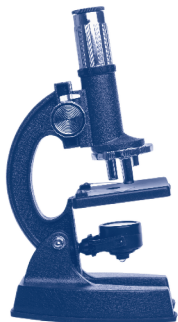
- Measure and estimate lengths in standard units.
 - Measure the length of an object by selecting and using appropriate tools, such as
 - rulers
 - yardsticks
 - meter sticks
 - measuring tape
 - Measure the length of an object twice, using length units of different lengths for the two measurements.
 - Describe how the two measurements relate to the size of the unit chosen.
 - Estimate lengths, using
 - units of inches
 - feet
 - centimeters
 - meters
 - Measure to determine how much longer one object is than another.
 - Express the length difference in terms of a standard length unit.
- Relate addition and subtraction to length.
 - Use addition and subtraction within 100 to solve word problems involving lengths (same units).
 - Represent whole numbers as lengths from 0 on a number line diagram with equally spaced points corresponding to the numbers 0, 1, 2, etc.
 - Represent whole-number sums and differences within 100 on a number line diagram.
- Work with time and money.
 - Tell and write time from analog and digital clocks to the nearest five minutes, using a.m. and p.m.
 - Solve word problems involving money.
 - Solve problems that include the following forms of currency
 - dollar bills
 - quarters
 - dimes
 - nickels
 - pennies
 - Use \$ and ¢ symbols appropriately
- Represent and interpret data.
 - Generate measurement data by measuring lengths of several objects to the nearest whole unit.
 - Make repeated measurements of the same object.

A line plot where the horizontal scale is marked off in whole number units

- Show the measurements by making a line plot.
- Draw a picture graph and a bar graph (with single-unit scale) to represent a data set with up to four categories.
- Solve simple put together, take apart, and compare problems using information presented in a bar graph.

IV. Geometry

- Reason with shapes and their attributes.
 - Recognize and draw shapes having specified attributes, such as
 - a given number of angles
 - a given number of equal faces
 - Identify triangles, quadrilaterals, pentagons, hexagons, and cubes.
 - Partition a rectangle into rows and columns of same-size squares.
 - Count to find the total number.
 - Partition circles and rectangles into two, three, or four equal shares.
 - Describe shares using the words halves, thirds, half of, a third of, etc.
 - Describe the whole as two halves, three thirds, four fourths.
 - Recognize that equal shares of identical wholes need not have the same shape.



Teachers: Effective instruction in science requires hands-on experience and observation. In the words of the report from the National Academies of Science, *A Framework for K-12 Science Education*, "...children have surprisingly sophisticated ways of thinking about the world, based in part on their direct experiences with the physical environment, such as watching objects fall or collide and observing plants and animals. They also learn about the world through everyday activities, such as talking with their families, pursuing hobbies, watching television, and playing with friends. As children try to understand and influence the world around them, they develop ideas about their role in that world and how it works. In fact, the capacity of young children—from all backgrounds and socioeconomic levels—to reason in sophisticated ways is much greater than has long been assumed. Although they may lack deep knowledge and extensive experience, they often engage in a wide range of subtle and complex reasoning about the world. Thus, before they even enter school, children have developed their own ideas about the physical, biological, and social worlds and how they work. By listening to and taking these ideas seriously, educators can build on what children already know and can do."

While experience counts for much, book learning is also important, for it helps bring coherence and order to a child's scientific knowledge. Only when topics are presented systematically and clearly can children make steady and secure progress in their scientific learning. The child's development of scientific knowledge and understanding is in some ways a very disorderly and complex process, different for each child. But a systematic approach to the exploration of science, one that combines experience with book learning, can help provide essential building blocks for deeper understanding at a later time.

I. Properties of Matter

Teachers: Through reading aloud, observation, and activities such as describing and sorting different kinds of matter, explore the following with students:

A. Introduction to Matter

- Matter is anything that has mass and takes up space.
- There are many types of matter;
 - solid, liquid, gas

B. Properties and Uses of Matter

- Matter has properties that can be measured:
 - size, weight, volume
- Matter can be sorted, or classified, by properties.

C. Heating and Cooling Matter

- The state of matter depends on temperature.
- Heating or cooling a substance can change its properties.
 - Water has three states: liquid, solid (ice), and gas (water vapor).

D. Building with Matter

- Some objects are made from a single type of matter.
- Other objects are made from different types of matter being combined or placed together.

II. Organisms and Their Habitats

Teachers: Through reading aloud, observation, and activities such as investigating differences in the variety of plants and animals in different environments, help students to explore the following:

A. Plant Needs

- Plants have body parts (roots, stems, leaves) to survive and grow.
- Plants are living organisms and typically grow in fixed locations.

Review and extend learning from Kindergarten, Needs of Plants and Animals.

- Though there are many different types of plants, they have common needs (air, water, minerals, light).

B. Plant Diversity

- Plants are diverse in size, structure, and ecological needs.
- Plants live in environments to which they are suited; those environments also differ:
 - Deciduous forests (oak trees)
 - Tropical forests (vines, epiphytes)
 - Meadows and prairies (grasses)
 - Deserts (cacti)
 - Tundra (plants of small size)
 - Ponds, lakes, rivers, and streams
 - Oceans are home to less than a dozen known species of plants.
- Many plant habitats change in cycles over time—seasons—and plants are adapted to survive during those changes.

C. Animal Needs

- Adult plants and animals reproduce.
- Many kinds of animal parents take care of their offspring until the offspring become mature enough to care for themselves.

D. Animal Diversity

- Animals are diverse in size, shape, and ecological needs.
- Animals vary in their structure:
 - Invertebrates: without backbones (snails, insects, coral)
 - Vertebrates: with backbones (mammals, birds, fish, reptiles, and amphibians)
- Animals live in environments to which they are suited; those environments differ:
 - Deciduous forests (squirrels, raccoons)
 - Tropical forests (moles, worms)
 - Meadows and prairies (prairie dogs)
 - Deserts (lizards, scorpions)
 - Tundra (arctic fox, polar bears)
 - Ponds, lakes, rivers, and streams (fish, oysters)
 - Oceans (There are numerous species of animals in the world's oceans such as sea stars and whales.)

E. Ecosystems: Plant and Animal Relationships

- Many plants and animals live in a specific habitat.
- Organisms that share a given space affect each other.
 - Animals depend on plants for food and shelter.
 - Plants depend on animals (for example, pollination, seed dispersal).
- There are also groups of living things that are neither plants nor animals (fungi, algae, bacteria).

III. Exploring Land and Water

Teachers: Through reading aloud, observation, and activities such as developing models of the shapes and kinds of land and water in an area, help students to explore the following:

A. Landforms

- Earth's surface has various landforms such as:
 - plains, hills, plateaus, mountains, valleys, canyons, buttes, basins, cliffs, beaches, dunes, underwater mountains and valleys

- Maps are models of Earth’s surface.
 - A globe is a spherical map of Earth that helps to visualize locations of continents, the poles, and the equator.

B. Earth’s Water

- Most of Earth’s surface is covered with water.
- Most of Earth’s water is liquid; some is solid (ice); some is fresh water (rivers, lakes, groundwater, glaciers); most is salt water (ocean).

C. Effects of Wind and Water on Land

- Wind and water can change the shape of land.
- Wind and water produce many distinctive landforms:
 - dunes, beaches, cliffs, hoodoos, arches, oxbows and meanders, canyons, mesas
- Wind and water cause relatively slow changes to Earth’s crust.
- Scientists and engineers work together to design solutions that slow or prevent unwanted weathering and erosion.

IV. Electricity and Magnetism

Teachers: The emphasis in Grade 2 should be on observation, description, and explanation of real world applications of electricity and magnetism; technical explanations of electromagnetism should be taken up in later grades; see Grades 4, 5, 6, and 8 for an increasingly detailed study of energy, electricity, and magnetism.

Students should also engage with the engineering design process and its relationship to scientific knowledge. Contextualized design challenges should be embedded across multiple topics of study such as this domain, including in the later grades; for example, see Grades 3, 4, and 5 for an increasingly detailed study of engineering design. At this grade level, explore the following with students:

Collaborate with your fourth grade colleagues regarding future expectations and definitions of energy, transfer, and the transformation of energy (Grade 4, Energy Transfer and Transformation).

A. Electricity

- Electricity is a form of energy; it can cause changes.
- Matter contains two types of electrical charges: positive and negative.
- Types of electricity:
 - Static electricity: electric charges on the surface of things
 - Current electricity: electrical charges flowing in a circuit through wires and other devices

B. Magnets and Magnetism

- Magnet: a metal object that can exert a force through a distance on certain types of metal objects.
- A magnet has two poles: north and south.
- Similar magnetic poles attract each other; opposite magnetic poles repel each other.

C. Designing and Engineering Useful Devices

- Electricity and magnetism are used in many useful devices.
- All useful devices are developed through engineering design, a process which includes:
 - Defining a problem
 - Developing possible solutions
 - Refining (optimizing) the design solution
- Scientists and engineering designers often work together in teams to solve problems and design effective solutions.

D. Safe Use of Electricity and Magnetism

- Electricity is potentially dangerous.

- Safety rules for electricity include:
 - never put your finger or anything metallic in an electrical outlet.
 - never touch a switch or electrical appliance when your hand or body is wet.
 - never put your finger in a lamp socket.

V. The Human Body: Cells and Digestion

Emphasis at this grade is to introduce the hierarchy of structures in the body.

Review and extend learning from Kindergarten and Grade 1, Our Five Senses and Human Body Systems

A. Cells, Tissues, and Organs

- All living things are made up of cells too small to be seen without a microscope.
- The human body is made up of different types of cells including: stem, bone, blood, muscle, fat, skin, nerve.
- Cells combine to form tissues.
- Tissues combine to form organs.
- Organs combine to form organ systems.

B. Digestive and Excretory Systems

- The human body has complex systems, including the digestive and excretory systems.
 - The digestive system includes body parts that take in and process food (salivary glands, taste buds, teeth, esophagus, stomach, liver, small intestine, large intestine).
 - The excretory system includes those body parts that eliminate some kinds of wastes (kidneys, bladder, urethra).

C. Taking Care of Your Body

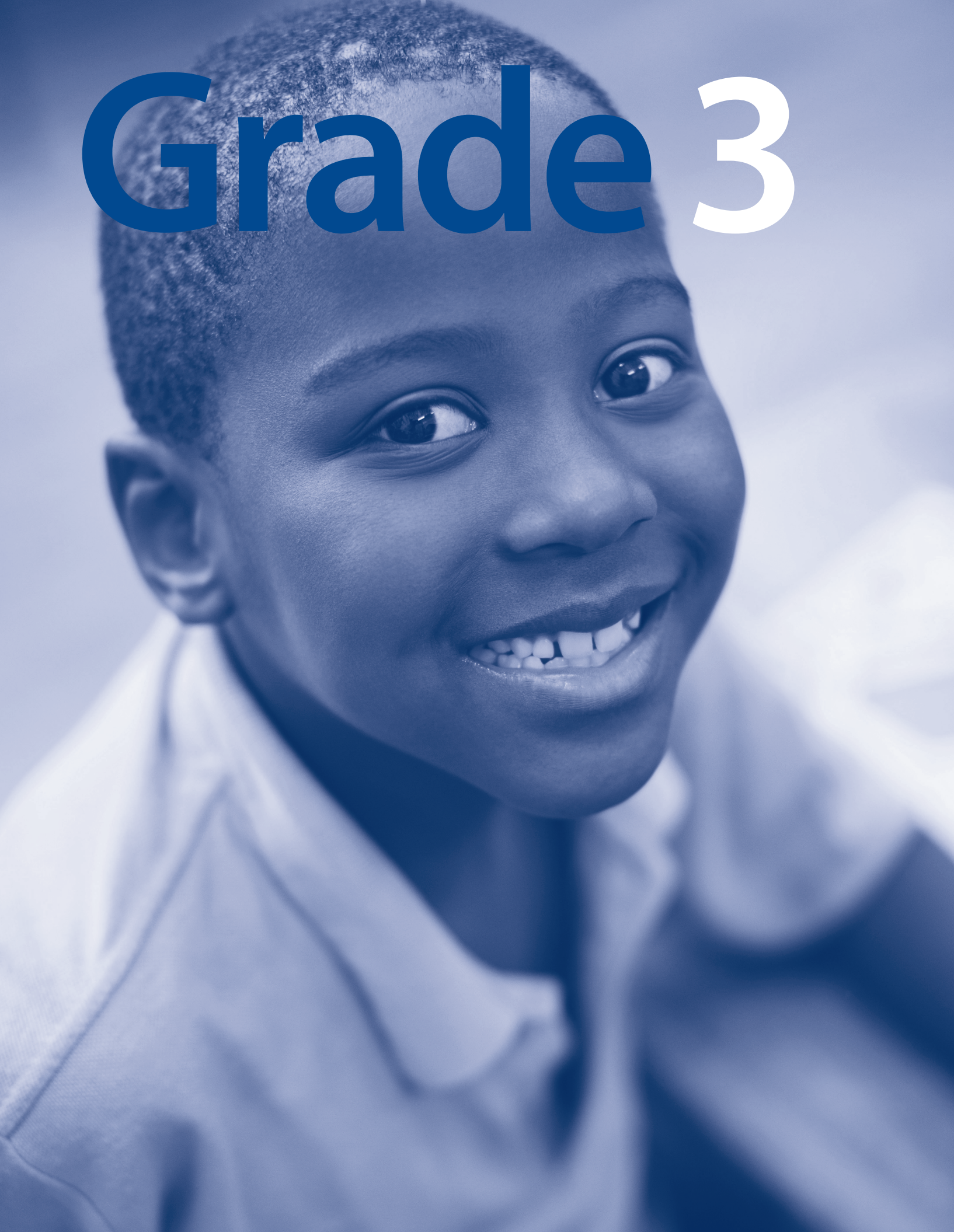
- A healthy lifestyle involves performing certain behaviors and avoiding other behaviors.
- The body needs specific foods, vitamins, and minerals in certain quantities to function properly.
- Organizations make recommendations about what nutrients people need to stay healthy.
- Vaccinations can help protect health.

VI. Science Biographies

Teachers: Through reading aloud and activities, explore with students the stories and accomplishments of these scientists and engineers. This list of science biographies is by no means exhaustive. Other individuals can be incorporated into learning during a corresponding topic of study for this grade level, and should include:

- Dmitri Mendeleev—developed the periodic table
- John James Audubon—artist specializing in American birds
- Marie Tharp—pioneer in mapping the ocean floor
- Louis Pasteur—explored bacteria and the safety of foods

Grade 3



Overview of Topics

Grade 3

ENGLISH LANGUAGE ARTS

- I. Listening and Speaking
 - A. Classroom Discussion
 - B. Presentation of Ideas and Information
- II. Reading
 - A. Phonics: Decoding and Encoding
 - B. Oral Reading and Fluency
 - C. Reading Comprehension and Response—All Texts
 - D. Reading Comprehension—Fiction, Drama, Poetry
 - E. Reading Comprehension—Nonfiction and Informational Text
- III. Writing
 - A. Writing to Reflect Audience, Purpose, and Task
 - B. Conducting Research
 - C. Narrative Writing
 - D. Informative/Explanatory Writing
 - E. Persuasive Writing/Opinion
- IV. Language Conventions
 - A. Command of Language
 - B. Spelling
 - C. Grammar
 - D. Capitalization and Punctuation
 - E. Vocabulary
- V. Poetry
- VI. Fiction
 - A. Myths and Mythical Characters
 - B. Literary Terms
- VII. Sayings and Phrases

HISTORY AND GEOGRAPHY

WORLD HISTORY AND GEOGRAPHY

- I. World Geography
 - A. Spatial Sense
 - B. Geographical Terms and Features
 - C. Canada
 - D. Important Rivers of the World
- II. The Ancient Roman Civilization
 - A. Geography of the Mediterranean Region
 - B. Background
 - C. The Empire
 - D. The “Decline and Fall” of Rome
 - E. The Eastern Roman Empire: Byzantine Civilization
- III. The Vikings

AMERICAN HISTORY AND GEOGRAPHY

- I. The Earliest Americans
 - A. Crossing from Asia to North America
 - B. Native Americans
- II. Early Exploration of North America
 - A. Early Spanish Exploration and Settlement
 - B. Exploration and Settlement of the American Southwest
 - C. The Search for the Northwest Passage
- III. The Thirteen Colonies: Life and Times Before the Revolution
 - A. Geography
 - B. Southern Colonies
 - C. New England Colonies
 - D. Middle Atlantic Colonies

VISUAL ARTS

- I. Elements of Art
 - A. Light in Artworks
 - B. Space in Artworks
 - C. Design: How the Elements of Art Work Together
- II. Native American Art
- III. Art of Ancient Rome and Byzantine Civilization
- IV. Architecture

MUSIC

- I. Elements of Music
- II. Listening and Understanding
 - A. The Orchestra
 - B. Composers and Their Music
 - C. Musical Connections
- III. Songs

MATHEMATICS

- I. Operations and Algebraic Thinking
- II. Number and Operations in Base Ten
- III. Number and Operations—Fractions
- IV. Measurement and Data
- V. Geometry

SCIENCE

- I. Investigating Forces
 - A. Forces and Motion
 - B. The Force of Friction
 - C. Predicting Motion
 - D. The Force of Magnetism
- II. Life Cycles, Traits, and Variations
 - A. Organisms Have Life Cycles
 - B. Organisms have Traits
 - C. The Environment Affects Traits
 - D. Advantages of Specific Traits
- III. Habitats and Change
 - A. Living Things and Their Environments
 - B. Ecosystems and Environmental Change
 - C. Evidence of How Organisms and Environments Have Changed Over Time
- IV. Weather and Climate
 - A. Earth's Atmosphere
 - B. Wind: The Movement of Air
 - C. Weather and Climate
 - D. Reducing the Impact of Hazardous Weather
- V. The Human Body: Human Senses and Movement
 - A. The Muscular System
 - B. The Skeletal System
 - C. The Nervous System
 - D. Vision: How the Eye Works
 - E. Hearing: How the Ear Works
- VI. Science Biographies

Grade 3 | English Language Arts



The *Common Core State Standards for English Language Arts* emphasize the critical importance of building nonfiction background knowledge in a coherent and sequenced way within and across grades. This can be accomplished most effectively, at each grade level, by integrating the topics from history, geography, science, and the arts in the *Core Knowledge Sequence* into the language arts block. Note that in the *Sequence*, there are many cross-curricular connections to history and science topics within Language Arts (e.g., poems, stories, and sayings), as well as to visual arts and music, which can and should be integrated into the applicable domain of study.

I. Listening and Speaking

A. Classroom Discussion

- Maintain attention and actively participate in discussions about a variety of topics, ideas, and texts in a variety of settings including partners, small and large groups, and teacher-led groups.
- Prepare for discussions in advance, including reading about the topic and organizing information for the discussion. Draw on preparations during the discussion.
- Use agreed-upon rules for group discussions, e.g., look at and listen attentively to the speaker, raise hand to speak, take turns, keep discussions on-topic, and say “excuse me” or “please.”
- Ask relevant questions to clarify conversations and ideas and to build upon remarks made by others.
- Participate in a discussion by explaining their own ideas relevant to the topic or conversation.
- Understand and use narrative language to describe main ideas and supporting details in a text read aloud, such as people, places, things, locations, events, and actions.
- Understand and use narrative language to describe texts read aloud or presented in different formats, such as videos, recordings, pictures, graphs, and charts.
- Ask and answer questions about information presented orally, providing appropriate on-topic elaboration and detail.

B. Presentation of Ideas and Information

- Give a presentation about a topic or text, tell a story, or orally relate a personal experience including relevant details and facts.
- Make audio recordings of poems and stories, reading fluently and at an understandable volume and pace.
- Add visual displays to enhance certain facts and details in oral readings or presentations.
- Speak in complete sentences, providing appropriate details and clarification for multiple tasks and situations.

II. Reading

A. Phonics: Decoding and Encoding

- Identify and understand the meaning of common prefixes and suffixes.
- Decode words with common Latin suffixes.
- Decode and read multisyllable words at grade level.
- Read irregularly spelled words at grade level.

Note: Students should read outside of school at least 20 minutes daily.

B. Oral Reading and Fluency

- Read grade-level text fluently and accurately to support comprehension.
- Understand the purpose for reading a particular text.
- Orally read and reread grade-level poetry and prose to develop accuracy, appropriate pacing, and expression.
- Self-correct and develop understanding by rereading as necessary.

C. Reading Comprehension and Response—All Texts

- Independently read and comprehend longer works of fiction (chapter books, stories, plays, and poems) and nonfiction (science, history, and social studies) appropriately written for third grade or beyond.

Grasping Specific Details and Key Ideas

- Ask and pose plausible answers to *how*, *why*, and *what-if* questions in interpreting fiction and nonfiction texts read independently.
- Orally summarize main points from fiction and nonfiction readings.
- Make inferences, draw conclusions, and trace the development of themes.
- Support inferences, conclusions, and themes with evidence from the text.
- Understand how ideas develop in a text and the interactions between ideas, people, places, and events, and why they are important.

Observing Craft and Structure

- Point to specific words or passages that are causing difficulties in comprehension.
- Determine the meaning of words and phrases from a text that has been read independently, including denotative, connotative, and figurative meanings.
- Identify and use text features to locate and understand information (e.g., table of contents, index, chapters, scenes, stanzas, sidebars, captions, and key words).
- Determine their own point of view about a text and understand how it differs from that of the author, narrator, or characters in a text.

Integrating Information and Evaluating Evidence

- Prior to reading, identify what they know and have learned that may be related to the specific story or topic to be read.
- Make predictions prior to and while reading, based on the title, pictures, and/or text read thus far and then compare the actual outcomes to predictions.
- Use images accompanying the written text (e.g., illustrations, photographs, charts, and maps) to check and support understanding.
- Answer questions that require making interpretations, making judgments, or giving opinions about what is read independently.
- Interpret information that is read independently and then ask questions to clarify this information.
- Identify the important themes or key ideas in a text.
- Compare and contrast themes or key ideas across texts.

D. Reading Comprehension—Fiction, Drama, Poetry

- Retell a story, using narrative language to describe characters, setting(s), and the plot of the story in proper sequence.
- Identify the moral or lesson of a fable, folktale, or myth and identify the components that build it, including details such as the title, setting, characters, and how the story plays out.
- Describe characters in increasing depth by referring to dialogue and/or their actions in the story.
- Explain how characters' actions, words, and motivations affect the plot of a story.

- Demonstrate understanding of literary language (e.g., author, illustrator, characters, setting, plot, dialogue, personification, simile, and metaphor) and use some of these terms when discussing fiction, drama, or poetry.
- Distinguish between literal and figurative language and be able to explain the meaning of figurative language in a text.
- Distinguish between poems, plays, and stories, including the components of each (e.g., stanzas, scenes and acts, and chapters) and how the components affect the whole.
- Identify the point(s) of view of the narrator(s) and characters in a text; distinguish their own opinion or point of view from that of the narrator or characters.
- Understand and explain how illustrations impact stories by showing aspects of a character or setting and creating a specific mood.
- Identify and describe the theme, setting, and plot of a story; compare the themes, settings, and plots of stories written by the same author (as in a series).

E. Reading Comprehension—Nonfiction and Informational

- Answer questions about the details of a nonfiction text, indicating which part of the text provides the information needed to answer specific questions.
- Locate the main ideas in a text and distinguish them from details. Explain how details support big ideas.
- Identify the structure of a text, section of text, paragraph, or sentence (e.g., comparison, cause/effect, problem/solution, compare/contrast, sequence, or main idea and details) and describe how it connects and communicates ideas in the text.
- Understand how historical events, scientific ideas, or steps in a procedure are related in a text and use language pertaining to sequence or cause/effect to explain how or why they happened.
- Identify and determine the meaning of Tier 2 academic vocabulary and Tier 3 domain-specific vocabulary in informational text.
- Locate relevant information in a print or digital text using text features and search tools such as key words, sidebars, and hyperlinks.
- Understand the author's point of view or opinion about a nonfiction subject and distinguish it from their own.
- Use both words and images (e.g., photos, maps, and diagrams) in an informational text to answer *where*, *when*, *why*, and *how* questions relevant to the text.
- Compare and contrast the information in nonfiction texts on similar subjects.

III. Writing

A. Writing to Reflect Audience, Purpose, and Task

- Write routinely, completing both short and long assignments focused on a range of different tasks, purposes, and audiences.
- Produce a variety of types of writing—such as stories, reports, poems, letters, descriptions, and arguments—and make reasonable judgments about what to include in their own written works based on the purpose and type of composition.
- Know how to use established conventions when writing a friendly letter: heading, salutation (greeting), closing, and signature.
- Organize material in paragraphs and understand
 - how to use a topic sentence.
 - how to develop a paragraph with examples and details.
 - that each new paragraph is indented.
- In some writings, proceed with guidance through a process of gathering information, organizing thoughts, composing a draft, revising to clarify and refine their meaning, and proofreading with attention to spelling, mechanics, and presentation of a final draft.

- Use keyboards, tablets, and other technologies to produce and publish writing as well as to collaborate and communicate with others.

B. Conducting Research

- Conduct short research projects to demonstrate knowledge gathered and learned about a topic.
- Gather information from personal experiences as well as from print and digital sources (e.g., a children’s encyclopedia, approved online sources, videos, and recordings).
- Take notes from sources.
- Organize information from research notes into categories provided by the teacher.

C. Narrative Writing

- Produce narrative pieces that reflect real-life or imagined experiences
- Introduce a narrator and characters and develop them through dialogue and exposition, including actions, thoughts, feelings, and reactions to events in the plot.
- Organize a logical sequence of plot events, using time-order words to indicate event order.
- Provide a beginning that introduces the story, a middle that develops story events, and an ending that gives a sense of closure.

D. Informative/Explanatory Writing

- Write a short report that clearly presents ideas and information in their own words.
- Introduce a topic with information organized in related sections or paragraphs and developed with facts, definitions, and details.
- Include visual elements such as photos, drawings, or diagrams to help explain or present ideas or information when appropriate.
- Use linking words to connect ideas (e.g., *also, another, and, more, but, however, therefore, in addition*).
- Write a conclusion that wraps up ideas in the text.

E. Persuasive Writing/Opinion

- Introduce an opinion and support it with reasons or evidence.
- Use linking words to connect their opinion with reasons (e.g., *another, more, but, also, however, therefore, in addition*).
- Write a conclusion that wraps up the argument.

IV. Language Conventions

A. Command of Language

- Use knowledge of language conventions when reading, writing, speaking, and listening.
- Identify differences between written and spoken English.
- Apply word choices to create meaning and effect.

B. Spelling

- Spell most words correctly or with a highly probable spelling.
- Apply current code knowledge to spelling.
- Spell most grade-level high-frequency words correctly.
- Spell words correctly when adding plurals, suffixes, and other known endings.
- Use knowledge of word patterns, word families, word parts, and ending rules to spell correctly.
- Use dictionaries or glossaries—print and digital—to check and correct spellings about which they are uncertain.